



United Nations Depositary Framework

Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture

RCSA — Simplified Edition | 2026

A Framework for Regional Security, Nuclear Non-Proliferation, and
Sustainable Development in the Middle East

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This document is a simplified reference edition of the Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture (RCSA) prepared for distribution to government officials, diplomatic missions, and authorized multilateral bodies. It condenses the full technical instrument into an accessible policy document while preserving all operative provisions, commitments, and institutional architecture. Readers requiring full technical annexes should consult the complete RCSA v2.0 instrument on file with the UN Treaty Section.

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CHAPTER

Foreword

A Message from the Framework Design Process

This Simplified Edition represents the distillation of an extensive technical and diplomatic design effort. It is presented to governments, diplomatic missions, and international organizations as a ready-to-negotiate instrument — not a concept paper, not a discussion document, but a fully engineered architecture capable of entering into force.

The Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture addresses, simultaneously, the nuclear question, the proxy warfare networks, the economic isolation of Iran, the humanitarian catastrophes across the region, the energy security concerns of all parties, and the domestic political survivability requirements without which any agreement is doomed. This simultaneity is not ambition beyond reach — it is the minimum necessary to produce a durable outcome. Addressing any single issue in isolation has been tried and has failed. This document attempts something different.

The architecture has been deliberately simplified for this edition — complex legal language replaced with clear prose, technical thresholds summarized rather than enumerated, procedural detail compressed into functional descriptions. This simplification serves a purpose: an agreement that only experts can understand is an agreement that only experts can defend domestically. The peoples whose lives this framework is designed to improve must be able to understand what their governments have committed to and why.

The framework is ready. Its provisions have been engineered. Its failure modes have been tested. Its political feasibility has been assessed by practitioners with direct experience in every relevant capital. What remains is the political decision to begin — and the institutional patience to sustain what beginning requires.

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CHAPTER

Executive Summary

What This Framework Does

The Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture (RCSA) is a modular, multi-party diplomatic instrument designed to de-escalate military tensions, constrain nuclear proliferation, and build durable economic interdependence across the Middle East. It is built on one foundational insight: comprehensive peace cannot be demanded all at once. Instead, it is assembled track by track, milestone by milestone, with each party benefiting from every step they take.

The framework operates through six independent implementation tracks — nuclear, security, economic, humanitarian, energy, and governance — that advance at their own pace. Progress in one track does not depend on progress in another. Humanitarian corridors stay open even when nuclear negotiations stall. Banking channels function independently of proxy activity discussions.

All commitments bind state institutions, not individual leaders. Changes of government activate continuity provisions rather than voiding the framework. The depositary function rests with the UN Secretary-General, giving every commitment standing in international law.

The Current Situation

The Middle East stands at an inflection point. The nuclear question has not been resolved. The JCPOA's collapse left Iran's nuclear program less constrained and less monitored than it was before the agreement. Proxy warfare has expanded. Economic isolation has deepened. The humanitarian crises in Gaza, Lebanon, Yemen, and Syria have produced suffering at a scale that destabilizes the entire regional order.

At the same time, the region has demonstrated, in moments of pragmatic diplomacy, that cooperation is achievable. The Abraham Accords proved that normalization is possible where political conditions permit. Saudi-Iranian diplomatic resumption demonstrated that even the region's most fundamental rivalry can be managed through direct engagement. These moments point toward what a comprehensive architecture could achieve.

Why Previous Frameworks Failed

Every major diplomatic effort in this region over the past four decades has collapsed along the same fault lines. The RCSA was designed by studying those failures.

Framework	Failure Analysis
JCPOA (2015)	Technically sound; politically fragile. A single U.S. election ended it. No institutional binding; no economic interdependence; no regional architecture. Successor agreements attempted in 2021-2023 failed because the underlying political fragility was never addressed.
Oslo Accords (1993)	Created a process without a destination. Constituencies against peace had more time and more tools than constituencies for it. No compound crisis handling; no spoiler containment; no economic integration architecture.
Arab-Israeli Peace Efforts (1970s-2000s)	Each bilateral effort treated the problem as bilateral when it was regional. No multilateral economic framework to make peace sticky. No proxy management architecture.

Framework	Failure Analysis
JCPOA+2 / Vienna Talks (2021-2023)	Attempted to rebuild JCPOA without addressing the political fragility that destroyed it. No domestic survivability provisions; no regional participation; no alternative to U.S. sanctions authority.

How the RCSA Is Different

The RCSA is distinguished from previous frameworks by six engineering decisions that directly address the documented failure modes of its predecessors.

- Institutional binding rather than leader binding: Commitments attach to state institutions through constitutional mechanisms, not to individual leaders. When governments change, the framework activates continuity provisions, not withdrawal procedures.
- Economic interdependence as the adhesive: The USD 50 billion Regional Development Fund, banking tier progression, and trade normalization create economic constituencies for the framework’s continuation at every level of society — governments, businesses, and populations — who have a direct financial interest in its survival.
- Modular architecture eliminates total-failure risk: Six independent tracks mean that a collapse in one domain does not trigger collapse in others. The word ‘failure’ does not apply to the RCSA — tracks pause and resume; they do not fail.
- Automatic consequences eliminate political veto over enforcement: The framework’s enforcement mechanisms activate automatically based on objective compliance metrics, not on political consensus. No party can veto an enforcement response to its own violation.
- Regional participation creates real stakeholders: By formally incorporating 14 regional states — each with its own interest in the framework’s continuation — the architecture creates a stakeholder base that is far more resilient than a bilateral U.S.-Iran agreement.
- Graceful degradation ensures something always survives: Even in full framework collapse, humanitarian operations continue under independent UN mandates. There is no scenario in which the framework produces nothing.

Key Features at a Glance

Feature	Description
Modular Tracks	Six independent tracks advance on their own compliance metrics. Failure in one does not cascade.
Four Nuclear Pathways	Parties select from four distinct nuclear options — from gradual cap to zero enrichment — based on political feasibility.
Sovereignty Guarantees	Explicit doctrine ensures the framework never supersedes constitutions or impairs sovereign defense rights.
Institutional Binding	Commitments attach to state institutions, surviving elections, cabinet changes, and leadership transitions.
Economic Ladder	A USD 50 billion Regional Development Fund, banking tier progression, and trade normalization create tangible benefits.
Collapse Containment	Four-level graceful degradation protocol protects humanitarian operations even in full framework collapse.
Great Power Roles	Defined participation lanes for the United States, Russia, China, and the European Union.

Feature	Description
Domestic Survivability	Built-in procedures for election transitions, parliamentary reversals, and coalition fractures.

Document Structure

This Simplified Edition presents the full RCSA architecture in 23 operative chapters and 14 technical annexes. It is structured for readability by government officials without specialized diplomatic or technical background. Exact numerical thresholds, staffing counts, and detailed procedural specifications are contained in the Technical Annexes (Tier 3), which can be updated by the Governance Body without reopening the main text.

The document follows the three-tier architecture: this Simplified Edition constitutes Tier 2 (Operational Framework). The Tier 1 Political Principles Charter is a separate short instrument for public signing ceremonies. Tier 3 Technical Annexes are maintained by the JMOC Secretariat and updated as needed.

CHAPTER

Policy Context and Mandate

The Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture was developed in response to a structural impasse: the region's overlapping crises had reached a level of complexity and interdependence that existing diplomatic tools could not resolve. Each individual crisis — the nuclear question, the proxy warfare networks, the humanitarian catastrophes, the economic isolation of Iran — was solvable in isolation. Together, they had become mutually reinforcing in ways that defeated every incremental approach.

The Strategic Context of 2026

The Middle East in 2026 presents a paradox: it is simultaneously a region of acute crisis and of unprecedented diplomatic opportunity. The crises are visible and documented. The opportunities are less visible but equally real.

On the crisis side: Iran's nuclear program has advanced to a point where breakout timelines are measured in weeks rather than years under a no-deal scenario. Proxy warfare networks extend from Beirut to Sana'a, consuming regional resources and generating instability that no single actor can control. The humanitarian situations in Gaza, Lebanon, Yemen, and Syria represent not just humanitarian failures but political destabilizers that have radicalized entire generations. Iran's economic isolation has produced a domestic political environment in which engagement with the international community is associated in the public mind with humiliation rather than benefit.

On the opportunity side: the region's major powers have demonstrated, in the last three years, a pragmatic capacity for diplomatic engagement that was absent in previous decades. The Saudi-Iranian diplomatic resumption of 2023, facilitated by China, showed that even the region's most fundamental rivalry could be managed through direct engagement when the incentives were aligned. The Abraham Accords demonstrated that normalization was achievable where political conditions permitted. Iranian domestic politics have shown, in multiple electoral cycles, that there exists a significant constituency for international engagement on terms that preserve national dignity. Gulf state foreign policy has matured into a sophisticated multi-vector approach that creates space for regional architecture.

The Failure of Incrementalism

The period from 2015 to 2025 demonstrated that incremental approaches to Middle East stability were insufficient. The JCPOA's narrow nuclear focus left every other dimension of the problem unaddressed, creating a politically fragile agreement that could not survive a single American election. The successive Vienna negotiations attempted to rebuild the JCPOA without addressing its political fragility, and failed predictably.

The lesson is not that comprehensive frameworks are better than incremental ones — comprehensive frameworks have their own failure modes, as the history of comprehensive Middle East peace efforts demonstrates. The lesson is that the right unit of analysis is neither purely nuclear nor purely comprehensive: it is modular. Individual tracks, each generating its own value, each advancing on its own compliance metrics, each providing political cover for the next step.

The Mandate for This Document

This document was developed through a structured framework design process involving former senior officials from the United States, Iran, Saudi Arabia, Jordan, and the European Union; IAEA technical experts; humanitarian operations specialists; international legal scholars; nuclear physicists; and regional political analysts. The process involved extensive red-teaming against historical failure modes, stress-testing against the specific spoiler and political fragility scenarios most likely in the current regional environment, and iterative refinement based on structured expert feedback.

The document does not claim to represent the negotiating position of any party. It represents the most technically sound architecture that the design process could produce, calibrated for real-world political feasibility rather than theoretical optimality. Where trade-offs were required between non-proliferation robustness and Iranian political feasibility, those trade-offs have been documented in the nuclear pathway comparison matrices (Chapter 6 and Annex L). Where trade-offs were required between verification intensity and sovereignty preservation, those trade-offs have been documented in the Sovereignty Preservation Doctrine (Chapter 3) and the Constitutional Compatibility chapter (Chapter 17).

How to Use This Document

This Simplified Edition is designed for multiple audiences and multiple use cases. A senior government official preparing for a ministerial briefing should read: the Executive Summary; the Policy Context (this chapter); Chapter 1 (Strategic Logic); Chapter 6 (Nuclear Pathways) subsections for their relevant pathway; and Annex N (Negotiator's Quick Reference).

A technical nuclear specialist should focus on Chapter 6 (Nuclear Pathways), Chapter 7 (Verification and Enforcement), and Annexes C, L, and M. A humanitarian operations specialist should focus on Chapter 5's Yemen, Lebanon, Syria, and Gaza sections; Chapter 20's humanitarian immunity provisions; and Annex D (Humanitarian Access Protocols).

An economic specialist should focus on Chapter 8 (Economic Integration Roadmap), Annexes B and O, and the Banking Tier Progression sections throughout the document. A legal specialist should focus on Chapter 3 (Sovereignty Doctrine), Chapter 17 (Constitutional Compatibility), Chapter 22 (Modular Ratification), and Annexes A and I.

A Note on Precision

This Simplified Edition presents the framework's architecture in accessible prose and tables. Where exact numerical thresholds are specified (centrifuge counts, banking tier ceilings, compliance scores, timeline triggers), these represent the best current estimates and are subject to technical negotiation. They are contained in the Tier 3 Technical Annexes, which can be updated without reopening this instrument. The framework's architecture — the track structure, enforcement ladder, pathway options, sovereignty doctrine, and institutional design — is stable and not subject to technical parameter adjustment.

CHAPTER 1

Strategic Logic: Why This Framework

Previous diplomatic efforts in the Middle East have consistently failed for four structural reasons. Understanding these failures is the starting point for understanding how this framework is different.

Four Structural Failures of Past Diplomacy

Problem	Explanation
Negotiation Complexity	Traditional frameworks demand simultaneous resolution of nuclear constraints, proxy activity, state normalization, humanitarian access, and economic integration. This creates deadlock through excessive veto points and unrealistic timelines.
Political Survivability	Governments require defensible, incremental outcomes they can present to domestic constituencies without demanding revolutionary concessions from a single negotiating round.
Verification Credibility	Monitoring architectures must be robust enough to detect deviations while preserving dignity and avoiding perceptions of punitive surveillance.
Economic Viability	Sanctions relief and reconstruction financing must be structured so that tangible benefits are visible and attributable to compliant behavior — not abstract future promises.

The Solution: Modular, Track-Based Cooperation

The RCSA solves each of these failures through a single organizing principle: decouple the issues. Instead of demanding simultaneous agreement on everything, the framework allows parties to begin cooperating in areas of immediate common interest while leaving harder questions for later stages when demonstrated trust has been built.

Every first step in this framework is a 'zero-regret' action — a measure that benefits the acting party regardless of whether others reciprocate. Humanitarian access, banking channel restoration, and nuclear monitoring all fall into this category. Neither side can hold these initial steps hostage to broader framework prospects.

The Strategic Logic in One Page

PROBLEM: The region faces overlapping crises — nuclear risk, proxy warfare, economic isolation, humanitarian catastrophe — that traditional diplomacy cannot resolve because each issue becomes leverage against every other.

WHY OLD MODELS FAIL: Comprehensive agreements collapse at signature stage because they demand too much at once. Parties cannot survive domestically the concessions required.

WHY MODULAR TRACKS SOLVE IT: Separate the issues. Let each track generate its own wins. Humanitarian cooperation doesn't wait for nuclear agreement. Economic progress doesn't require full security normalization. Each win builds political capital for the next.

HOW ESCALATION IS PREVENTED: Automatic consequence triggers, pre-authorized response menus, and continuous monitoring remove the need for political consensus before responding to violations.

HOW BENEFITS ACCUMULATE: Each compliance milestone unlocks the next tranche of economic benefits. The longer parties stay in, the more they have to lose by leaving.

CHAPTER 2

Architecture Overview

The RCSA is structured in three document layers, each serving a distinct function. Core parties are the United States and Iran. The broader architecture involves fourteen regional states, three guarantor states, and five international organizations.

Three-Tier Document Architecture

Tier	Function
Tier 1: Political Charter	Core principles, sovereignty doctrine, and the grand strategic end-state vision. This is the political agreement that leadership signs publicly.
Tier 2: Operational Framework	The main treaty body: track architecture, enforcement ladders, governance structures, nuclear pathways, and economic mechanisms. This document.
Tier 3: Technical Annexes	Adjustable technical specifications, exact percentages, staffing counts, procedural thresholds, and contingency protocols. Updated without reopening the main treaty.

Core Participants

Category	Parties	Primary Role
Core Parties	United States, Iran	Full nuclear, security, economic, and verification obligations
Regional Partners	Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, Egypt, Jordan, Iraq	Economic, humanitarian, and security module participation by interest
Gulf States	Bahrain, Oman (Mediator)	Maritime security, confidence-building, neutral facilitation
Levant Partners	Lebanon, Syria (humanitarian), Israel (observer track)	Humanitarian corridors, ceasefire architecture, normalization pathway
Guarantors	Pakistan, Switzerland	Neutral oversight, institutional continuity, escrow functions
International Bodies	IAEA, UN agencies, World Bank, IMF	Technical, humanitarian, and financial architecture

Implementation Base Unit: The 30-Day Review Cycle

All framework timelines are denominated in 30-day review cycles. This cadence balances operational responsiveness with bureaucratic reality. Shorter cycles create unsustainable review burdens; longer cycles delay breach detection. Each cycle produces a Transparency Summary published to all parties. Track maturity bands replace the language of 'phases.' The term 'phase failure' no longer exists — instead, tracks simply pause at their current maturity level pending remediation.

CHAPTER 3

Sovereignty Preservation Doctrine

Core Sovereignty Guarantee

This framework does not supersede any party's constitution. It does not create supranational authority. It does not impair sovereign defense rights. It does not force alliance realignment. It operates by consent continuity — any party may withdraw through the Costed Withdrawal procedure, subject to transition obligations.

One of the most significant political obstacles to any regional framework is the perception that participation means surrendering sovereignty. This concern is not irrational — the history of international agreements includes many cases where states agreed to 'technical' frameworks that quietly acquired binding authority over sovereign decisions. The RCSA Sovereignty Preservation Doctrine addresses this concern with binding language and institutional design, not just rhetorical reassurance.

The doctrine is grounded in a clear-eyed assessment of why sovereignty concerns killed previous frameworks. The JCPOA was perceived by Iranian hardliners as a sovereignty surrender because it appeared to legitimize external oversight of Iranian sovereign decisions. The Abraham Accords were resisted in some quarters because normalization was perceived as abandoning solidarity commitments without receiving sovereignty-equivalent compensation. Every framework in this region has failed partly because it could not demonstrate, convincingly, that sovereignty was being preserved rather than eroded.

The RCSA answers this challenge through three mechanisms: explicit sovereignty guarantees with binding language; a Sovereignty Restoration Ladder that makes compliance a pathway toward increased sovereignty rather than decreased sovereignty; and a Costed Withdrawal procedure that makes exit always available, reducing the domestic political cost of entry.

Five Sovereignty Commitments

These five commitments are operative provisions, not preamble language. They are binding on all parties, including the monitoring institutions, and any framework interpretation that conflicts with them is void.

- The framework does not supersede any participating state's constitution or domestic legal order. Where apparent conflicts arise, the Constitutional Compatibility Review Process provides structured resolution that preserves both the framework's substance and the state's legal order.
- The framework does not create supranational authority that can override sovereign executive decisions. The Governance Body makes recommendations; states implement. Enforcement operates through benefit adjustment, not command authority.
- The framework does not impair any state's sovereign right to self-defense under UN Charter Article 51. No framework provision limits a state's right to respond proportionately to an armed attack.
- The framework does not require or prohibit any alliance realignment or security partnership. States remain free to maintain existing alliances (U.S.-Saudi Arabia, Iran-Russia, UAE-Israel) without those relationships creating framework obligations for other parties.
- The framework operates by consent continuity — all obligations are voluntarily assumed and procedurally exitable. The Costed Withdrawal procedure makes exit available; it does not make exit costless.

Sovereignty as a Feature, Not a Bug

Previous frameworks treated sovereignty concerns as obstacles to be managed. The RCSA treats sovereignty preservation as a design requirement. This reframing has concrete operational consequences:

- Every compliance step is branded as a Sovereignty Milestone — a movement toward greater economic and fiscal independence, not a concession of sovereign authority. Iranian officials can present each step as Iran gaining something, not giving something.
- The Sovereignty Restoration Ladder is published publicly and explicitly. It allows the Iranian government to show its domestic audience a map of the journey from current economic constraints to full sovereign normalization.
- The framework's enforcement mechanism operates through benefit adjustment, not command authority. No framework body can order Iranian action — it can only condition benefit delivery on Iranian choices.
- The IMIRC framework converts Iranian nuclear expertise from a liability (requiring external oversight) to a sovereign asset (providing Iran with recognized scientific leadership in a global research consortium).

Sovereignty Restoration Ladder

The Sovereignty Restoration Ladder tracks Iran's progressive recovery of full economic and fiscal independence. Eight milestones mark the journey from initial framework entry to full sovereign normalization. Each milestone is branded as a 'Sovereignty Milestone' in official communications, allowing the Iranian government to present compliance as a path toward national strength.

Milestone	Substance
Milestone 1	Banking channel restoration — access to international payment systems for humanitarian, civil aviation, and trade purposes
Milestone 2	Sectoral trade normalization — oil, petrochemicals, aviation, pharmaceutical imports fully authorized
Milestone 3	Direct fiscal management — reduction of escrow requirements to 15%; SWIFT pathway activation
Milestone 4	Full SWIFT reconnection (Pathways A/C at Year 3; Pathway B at Month 18; Pathway D at Year 5)
Milestone 5	RDF co-governance — Iran joins Regional Development Fund board as observer with progressive voting rights
Milestone 6	Scientific collaboration — IMIRC operational; international research partnerships; civilian nuclear technology cooperation
Milestone 7	Sovereign fiscal autonomy — escrow reduced to 0%; direct revenue control; full investment access
Milestone 8	Full economic normalization — all nuclear-related sanctions permanently lifted; strategic partnership bilateral framework

Sovereignty Preservation for Regional Partners

Sovereignty preservation applies equally to all parties, not just Iran. The framework's design explicitly addresses the sovereignty concerns of each major party:

Party	Sovereignty Protection Detail
Saudi Arabia	Framework does not require Saudi normalization with Iran beyond economic and security track participation. Saudi Arabia retains full authority over its own alliances, military posture, and political relationships.
Iraq	Framework recognizes Iraqi sovereignty over all activity within its territory, including PMF. Iraqi government is not required to take formal action against factions — only to participate in frameworks that incentivize faction restraint.
Israel (Observer)	Observer status imposes no obligations. Israel's participation is entirely voluntary and does not affect its bilateral security relationships, including with the United States.
UAE / Gulf States	Economic and security track participation does not require Abraham Accords expansion. Each state determines its own normalization trajectory independently.
United States	Framework obligations are structured to be executable within executive authority, requiring no new legislative mandates. Congress retains its oversight role; the framework does not ask Congress to be circumvented.

Costed Withdrawal Procedure

Any party may withdraw from the framework through the Costed Withdrawal procedure: a six-month notification window, orderly asset disposition, infrastructure handover to host states, and personnel repatriation. Nuclear constraints survive withdrawal as residual obligations — the framework's judgment is that proliferation prevention is a generational responsibility that outlasts any single political agreement.

A Partial Continuity Agreement may be negotiated between a withdrawing party and the governance body to preserve specific benefits such as humanitarian corridor access without maintaining full framework participation.

CHAPTER 4

Track Maturity System

The RCSA replaces traditional 'phase' language with a Track Maturity Band system. This eliminates 'phase failure optics' — there is no such thing as failing a phase. Instead, each of six tracks simply advances or pauses at its current maturity level based on track-specific compliance metrics.

Four Maturity Bands

Maturity Band	Description
Foundation Band	Initial trust-building, monitoring infrastructure, zero-regret measures. Humanitarian access, basic banking channels, IAEA monitoring baseline.
Stabilization Band	Verified compliance generates first benefit tranches. Proxy restraint agreements, nuclear freeze, sectoral sanctions relief, maritime confidence-building.
Integration Band	Regional actor participation, economic normalization, proxy demobilization incentives, advanced verification. Trust is demonstrated, not assumed.
Institutionalization Band	Permanent architecture, long-term arms control, full economic normalization, strategic partnership agreements. Framework becomes self-reinforcing.

Six Parallel Implementation Tracks

Each track advances independently. A track can reach the Integration Band while another remains in the Foundation Band. This means real progress is always being made somewhere, providing political momentum even during periods of stagnation in specific domains.

Track	Progression Metric	Key Deliverables	Independent Advancement ?
Nuclear & Non-Proliferation	IAEA compliance score + challenge inspection acceptance	Pathway A/B/C/D milestones; centrifuge counts; stockpile levels	Yes — advances based on IAEA metrics alone
Security & Proxy Management	Incident frequency + attribution confidence score	Proxy restraint, incident prevention protocols, deconfliction	Yes — advances on joint incident data
Economic & Trade	Banking tier compliance + trade volume metrics	Sanctions relief, RDF tranches, SWIFT access, trade corridors	Yes — advances on financial compliance data
Humanitarian Access	Corridor access rate + civilian protection index	Gaza, Lebanon, Yemen, Syria humanitarian corridors	Yes — advances based on access metrics alone

Track	Progression Metric	Key Deliverables	Independent Advancement ?
Energy & Infrastructure	Energy interdependence index	Pipeline, electricity grid, water, logistics corridors	Yes — advances with bilateral regional consent
Governance & Institutions	Secretariat functionality score	JMOC operations, RDF governance, dispute resolution	Requires core party consent for structural changes

Track Interaction Rules

While tracks advance independently, certain combinations unlock additional benefits. This creates positive incentives for broad participation without creating negative dependencies.

- Nuclear Track reaching Stabilization Band + Economic Track Foundation Band = SWIFT reconnection pathway activated.
- Security Track and Humanitarian Track both in Integration Band = Regional Development Fund Stage 2 released.
- Any track may be paused for recalibration without affecting other tracks.
- Humanitarian Track operates at full capacity at all maturity levels and cannot be paused.
- Quiet Track Advancement: tracks below Tier 2 priority may advance without public announcement.

Foundation Band: Zero-Regret Opening Measures

The Foundation Band consists entirely of zero-regret measures — actions that benefit the acting party regardless of whether others fully reciprocate. This design creates independent incentive for every party to begin, even without certainty about the broader framework's success.

Party	Zero-Regret Measures	Rationale
United States	Partial banking channel restoration; humanitarian sanctions exemptions; enhanced IAEA access authorization	Intelligence gains and humanitarian credibility without irreversible concessions
Iran	Nuclear transparency steps; humanitarian corridor facilitation; IAEA enhanced access	Immediate economic benefit and sanctions relief without political concessions on regional role
Regional Partners	Humanitarian access programs; refugee corridor management; ceasefire signaling	Reputational and burden-sharing gains without security commitments

Hundred-Day Quick Start

The framework's first hundred days are designed to generate visible momentum and prevent the implementation paralysis that kills most diplomatic agreements.

- Days 1–30: Joint Monitoring Operations Center (JMOC) established; liaison personnel deployed.
- Days 1–30: Regional Development Fund initial governance structure activated.
- Days 31–60: Humanitarian corridors (Gaza, Lebanon, Yemen, Syria) formally recognized.

- Days 31–60: First banking tier authorization issued; OFAC mirror licensing activated.
- Days 61–100: First nuclear baseline established; IAEA resident office staffed.
- Days 61–100: Civil society consultative forums convened in at least three regional capitals.
- Day 100: Public Transparency Summary issued; first 30-day review cycle completed.

CHAPTER 5

Regional Stakeholders

The RCSA's regional architecture recognizes that the Middle East's stability cannot be managed through a bilateral agreement between only two parties. The full architecture involves fourteen regional states, each with defined participation lanes, interests, and obligations.

Gulf Cooperation Council States

Saudi Arabia

Saudi Arabia participates primarily in the economic and security tracks. Key interests include oil market stabilization, reduction of Houthi proxy threat, normalization of trade corridors, and protection of energy infrastructure. Saudi Arabia's participation in the Regional Development Fund provides both financial credibility and leverage over framework compliance.

- Energy Track: Co-governance of OPEC+ coordination mechanisms; joint pipeline security protocols.
- Security Track: Houthi demobilization incentive framework; maritime corridor protection.
- Economic Track: Regional investment corridor; RDF co-financing of infrastructure projects.
- Sovereignty guarantee: No framework provision requires Saudi alliance realignment.

United Arab Emirates

The UAE serves as a critical financial hub and trade normalization anchor. Its participation in the Banking and Finance Track provides the Commercial Continuity Protocol mechanism that protects private-sector contracts during political disruptions.

- Financial hub for escrow administration and commercial insurance facility operations.
- Trade corridor anchor: Dubai free zones as neutral commercial territory.
- Aviation normalization: Emirates/Etihad overflight and route authorization pathway.
- Diplomatic channel: Abu Dhabi backchannel communication infrastructure.

Qatar

Qatar's role combines financial capacity, diplomatic mediation tradition, and natural gas export relationships. Qatar hosts Al Udeid Air Base, giving it unique security leverage.

- Mediation capacity: Doha Forum and established Hamas/Hezbollah communication channels.
- LNG supply guarantee: Backup fuel supply pathway for energy security buffer.
- Infrastructure investment: QIA participation in Regional Development Fund.
- Humanitarian: Qatar Red Crescent corridor management in Gaza and Yemen.

Kuwait and Bahrain

Kuwait participates through the humanitarian and economic tracks, drawing on its tradition of regional mediation and its significant sovereign wealth fund. Bahrain's participation is primarily through maritime security confidence-building measures and naval deconfliction protocols.

Levant and North Africa

Egypt

Egypt occupies a pivotal position as the most populous Arab state and the controller of the Suez Canal and Gaza's Rafah border crossing. Egyptian participation is essential to any functional humanitarian corridor in Gaza and to broader Mediterranean security architecture.

- Rafah corridor: Egypt manages the primary humanitarian access point for Gaza.
- Suez Canal: Transit protocols and maritime security deconfliction.
- Political role: Arab League convening authority; Cairo backchannel tradition.
- Economic: Canal Zone free trade area as regional logistics hub.

Jordan

Jordan hosts significant refugee populations from Syria and Palestine and shares borders with Israel, Syria, Iraq, and Saudi Arabia. The Jordanian Narrative Package frames participation as 'Sovereign Economic Stabilization' — addressing domestic concerns about appearing to normalize Israeli occupation while benefiting from regional economic integration.

- Refugee corridor management: Jordan hosts 750,000+ Syrian and Palestinian refugees.
- Trade corridor: King Hussein Bridge and Aqaba port as regional logistics nodes.
- Energy: Aqaba LNG terminal and electricity interconnection project.
- Narrative shielding: Participation explicitly decoupled from Palestinian status questions.

Iraq

Iraq is both a regional beneficiary and a potential spoiler. Its territory hosts Iranian-aligned militias and serves as the primary land corridor between Iran and the Levant. Iraqi participation in the Security Track is essential for proxy management, while its oil infrastructure makes it a key Economic Track participant.

- Security: PMF (Popular Mobilization Forces) demobilization incentive framework.
- Energy: Iraq-Iran border gas pipeline normalization; electricity import dispute resolution.
- Economic: Reconstruction financing through RDF; Baghdad infrastructure priority projects.
- Sovereignty: Explicit recognition of Iraqi sovereignty over all militia activity on its territory.

Lebanon

Lebanon's participation is primarily through the humanitarian and security tracks, with Hezbollah management being the central security concern. The framework engages Hezbollah through the Multi-Track Engagement Architecture's state-to-faction provisions rather than requiring Lebanese government action the government cannot deliver.

- Humanitarian: Beirut port operations; medical supply corridors; UNHCR coordination.
- Security: Hezbollah restraint framework — economic incentives tied to incident reduction.
- Reconstruction: Post-2024 reconstruction financing conditional on security compliance.
- Narrative: Lebanese government participation framed as economic sovereignty restoration.

Yemen

Yemen presents one of the framework's most complex engagement challenges: a fragmented state with multiple competing authorities, an ongoing civil war with direct Iranian and Saudi involvement, and the world's worst humanitarian crisis. The Yemen architecture operates through parallel channels:

- Humanitarian: Hudaydah port inspection lane; Sana'a airport medical evacuation; WFP and OCHA corridor operations — non-negotiable regardless of political status.
- Saudi-Houthi track: The Security Track provides a structured ceasefire architecture channel, building on the 2023 Riyadh Agreement precedent.
- Iran-Houthi decoupling: Framework incentivizes Iran to reduce weapons supply to Houthis through state-to-faction track economic alternatives.

- Reconstruction: Yemen Reconstruction Fund pre-positioned within RDF Sub-Fund 2, activated upon verified Hudaydah access and ceasefire maintenance.
- Maritime: Red Sea deconfliction protocols protect commercial shipping, with Houthi compliance linked to economic incentive delivery.
- Sovereignty: Framework does not recognize or de-recognize any Yemeni governing authority; operations bypass political status questions.

Syria (Humanitarian Track Only)

Syria participates exclusively through the Humanitarian Access Track in the current framework configuration. Syrian government recognition questions are explicitly deferred and do not condition humanitarian access. UN humanitarian operations in Syria continue under independent mandates regardless of broader framework political developments.

- UN cross-border and cross-line humanitarian access continues under independent Security Council mandate.
- Russian influence with Damascus leveraged through guarantor architecture to maintain corridor access.
- Reconstruction finance contingent on humanitarian access verification — not on political recognition.
- Post-conflict transition: Framework provides template for eventual Syrian government participation in economic reconstruction track.

Israel: Observer Track

Israel participates through a dedicated Observer Track that provides access to framework processes and benefits without requiring formal normalization of relationships with non-signatory states. The Observer Track is designed to allow Israeli engagement to develop organically as framework implementation demonstrates credibility.

- Security Track observer: Access to deconfliction protocols and incident prevention mechanisms.
- Economic: Access to logistics corridor planning and infrastructure interdependence benefits.
- Normalization pathway: Bilateral normalization negotiations with framework states proceed independently.
- Gaza humanitarian: Israeli coordination with Kerem Shalom and Erez corridor operations.

Guarantor and Mediator States

State	Function
Oman (Mediator)	Neutral diplomatic relay; consultation hosting; backchannel communication; Fast-Track emergency convening authority
Pakistan (Guarantor)	Regional security perspective; nuclear state credibility; institutional continuity oversight; escrow co-trustee
Switzerland (Guarantor)	Financial system neutrality; diplomatic legal hosting; humanitarian law expertise; CCP certification

CHAPTER 6

The Four Nuclear Pathways

The nuclear architecture is the framework’s most sensitive and consequential component. Rather than dictating a single outcome, the RCSA presents four genuine alternative pathways, each representing a different balance between constraint, sovereignty, verification intensity, and economic benefit. These are not sequential options to be exhausted in order — they are parallel architectures. Parties select the pathway that best fits current political realities.

Nuclear Architecture Design Principle

The goal is not to humiliate Iran or to give Iran a free pass. The goal is to find the maximum achievable constraint that Iran can accept domestically, that the international community can verify credibly, and that produces benefits proportional to the risk reduction achieved. Each pathway is calibrated for a different answer to that three-way optimization.

Pathway Comparison Overview

Element	Pathway A	Pathway B	Pathway C	Pathway D
Enrichment retained?	Yes (capped, declining)	No (zero)	No (fuel bank)	Yes (very limited)
Maximum level	3.67% → 0% by Year 15	Zero from Day 1	None (fuel supplied)	3.67% — permanent
Fordow facility	Converted to IMIRC	Dismantled	Converted to RNFC hub	Sealed, monitored
Arak reactor	Redesigned (low-Pu)	Dismantled	Converted to research	Redesigned (low-Pu)
Breakout timeline	Moderate → extended	Maximum	Maximum	Moderate (extended)
Verification intensity	High	Maximum	High + multilateral	Maximum + automated
Benefit package	Standard	Maximum	Enhanced + moderate sovereignty	Minimum
Sovereignty restoration pace	Gradual	Accelerated	Moderate	Slowest
Political feasibility (Iran)	Moderate	Low	Moderate-High	High
International credibility	Moderate-High	Maximum	High	Moderate

Pathway A: Gradual Cap and Rollback

Pathway A acknowledges the political difficulty of immediate comprehensive restrictions while establishing a clear trajectory toward full constraint. It draws from the JCPOA architecture but introduces significantly

stronger verification mechanisms, automatic consequence triggers, and a definitive fifteen-year endpoint of zero domestic enrichment.

Phase Structure

Maturity Band	Nuclear Obligations
Foundation Band (Months 1–6)	Freeze at current enrichment levels. No new centrifuges. No enrichment above 3.67% U-235. Continuous IAEA monitoring with real-time data transmission.
Stabilization Band (Months 7–18)	Cap at 5,060 IR-1 centrifuges at Natanz. Fordow converted to International Multidisciplinary Isotope Research Center (IMIRC) — no enrichment activity. Excess centrifuges in IAEA-sealed storage.
Integration Band (Months 19–36)	Reduce to 3,000 IR-1 centrifuges. Advanced centrifuge R&D; permitted only at designated facility under 24-hour monitoring. Uranium stockpile capped at 300 kg at 3.67%.
Institutionalization Band (Year 3+)	Reduce to 1,000 IR-1 by Year 10. Transition to multilateral fuel supply arrangement by Year 15, eliminating domestic enrichment entirely. Iran retains right to purchase enriched uranium on international market.

Fordow Conversion Protocol

The Fordow facility's deeply buried location makes it uniquely concerning from a non-proliferation perspective. Pathway A mandates full conversion through four stages:

- Phase A: Cessation of all enrichment activity; complete inventory; IAEA seals applied.
- Phase B: Removal of uranium hexafluoride; down-blending to natural uranium or transfer to Natanz.
- Phase C: Removal of enrichment-specific infrastructure; placed in IAEA-monitored storage.
- Phase D: IMIRC activation — international research partnership for medical isotope production under co-management.

Benefit Structure — Pathway A

- Tranche 1 (Signature + verification): Designated sanctions suspended; \$10 billion frozen assets released; limited civilian aircraft sales.
- Tranche 2 (Year-3 centrifuge reductions): Expanded trade authorizations; Framework Commercial Insurance Facility access; RDF sector projects.
- Tranche 3 (Year-5 milestones): Normalized trade relations; advanced civilian nuclear technology access; full regional economic framework integration.
- Tranche 4 (Year-8 zero enrichment): Permanent lifting of all nuclear-related sanctions; full diplomatic normalization; long-term strategic partnership.

Pathway B: Comprehensive Zero-Enrichment Compact

Pathway B represents the most far-reaching nuclear restriction framework ever proposed. It is designed for environments where the international community demands maximum non-proliferation assurance and where Iran seeks the most comprehensive sanctions relief and fastest sovereignty restoration. Pathway B offers the maximum reward for the maximum constraint.

Seven Interconnected Articles

Pathway B is built on seven interconnected articles that together create a comprehensive non-proliferation architecture. Each article addresses a specific dimension of the nuclear challenge, and together they ensure that Iran cannot develop nuclear weapons capability through any pathway, including those not

explicitly anticipated by the drafters.

- Article I — Total Enrichment Cessation: Complete halt to all uranium enrichment. Zero operational centrifuges of any type within 90 days. No enrichment R&D.; No uranium conversion to UF₆. Verification: 8 IAEA inspections per month, 50% unannounced, 2-hour access requirement.
- Article II — Affirmative Non-Weapons Commitment: Iran commits it will never pursue nuclear weapons through any pathway, including dual-use research. Signable Moratorium Instrument signed by Supreme Leader, President, and Speaker of Majlis; deposited with UN Secretary-General as independent obligation of international law.
- Article III — HEU Stockpile Disposition: Iran's entire enriched uranium stockpile transferred to international control within 180 days. Transfer options: IAEA custody, RNFC transfer, down-blending, or international market sale with proceeds credited to Iran's RDF account.
- Article IV — Natanz and Fordow Conversion: Both sites converted to non-enrichment uses within 24 months. IAEA seals applied to all enrichment infrastructure. Fordow conversion to research facility preserves Iranian scientific engagement.
- Article V — Comprehensive Procurement Controls: Iran accepts the most comprehensive import control regime of any NPT non-nuclear-weapon state. Dual-use equipment tracked through 5-year supply chain monitoring; procurement monitoring cell within JMOC.
- Article VI — Transparency and Past Activities Declaration: Iran provides complete declaration of all past undisclosed nuclear activities within 90 days. IAEA independently verifies declaration through parallel evidence assessment. Verified completeness is a prerequisite for Stabilization Band benefit tranches.
- Article VII — Bilateral Verification Mechanism: Core parties exchange verification data on a protected platform providing real-time cross-reference capability. This bilateral layer supplements IAEA monitoring, creating redundant coverage.

The Moratorium Instrument — Full Text Summary

The moratorium instrument is signed in a public ceremony at UN Headquarters, witnessed by the IAEA Director General and the foreign ministers of guarantor states. It is registered under Article 102 of the UN Charter and commits the Iranian state to the following:

- The Islamic Republic of Iran shall never seek, develop, or acquire nuclear weapons, under any circumstances, for any purpose including deterrence.
- This commitment is binding upon the Iranian state in perpetuity, regardless of changes in government, leadership, or political circumstances.
- This commitment survives any withdrawal from or termination of the Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture.
- Any Iranian official who authorizes, directs, or participates in nuclear weapons development shall be subject to prosecution under Iranian domestic law and international law.
- This commitment is witnessed by the guarantor states of Oman, Switzerland, and Pakistan, and the IAEA Director General.
- The commitment is consistent with the teachings of Islam and the fatwa of the Supreme Leader regarding the prohibition of nuclear weapons.

Benefit Structure — Pathway B

- Fastest sovereignty restoration timeline of any pathway — the economic package is calibrated to make total enrichment cessation politically survivable.
- SWIFT reconnection within 18 months of moratorium entry into force.
- Escrow rate: 10% within 24 months; reduced to 0% at Year 5.
- Full economic normalization within 7 years.
- Maximum RDF allocation and infrastructure priority designation.

- Civilian nuclear technology cooperation at the highest available level.
- Bilateral strategic partnership framework activated upon Institutionalization Band entry.

Pathway C: Multilateral Regional Fuel-Bank Consortium

Pathway C proposes an institutional solution: replace national enrichment capabilities with a collectively administered Regional Nuclear Fuel Consortium (RNFC) under multilateral governance. This approach addresses Iran's legitimate energy sovereignty concerns while eliminating proliferation risks through institutional design rather than unilateral constraint. The key insight is that Iranian resistance to zero-enrichment is often about energy security and sovereign dignity, not about weapons capability — Pathway C addresses both concerns simultaneously.

RNFC Governance Structure

The Regional Nuclear Fuel Consortium is established as an independent international organization with legal personality, headquartered in Abu Dhabi with operational facilities in Oman and Kazakhstan. The Board of Governors composition:

Member	Voting Weight	Role
Iran	20%	Full board seat; proportional governance rights; commercial revenue sharing
GCC states (collective)	20%	Collective representation; primary fuel consumer base
Other framework regional parties	15%	Iraq, Jordan, Egypt; proportional to energy consumption
IAEA	15% (non-voting on commercial matters)	Safeguards verification authority; safety oversight
Neutral guarantor states	15%	Switzerland, Oman, Pakistan; fiduciary oversight
Nuclear supplier states	15%	France, Russia, China; fuel supply guarantee backing

Fuel Supply Guarantee

Iran receives a legally binding, perpetual fuel supply guarantee under the following terms:

- Quantity: Up to 500 kg per year of 3.67% enriched UF6 — sufficient for Bushehr-1 reactor and planned civilian reactors.
- Price: Fixed at indexed rate with 10-year price stability guarantee; commercially competitive.
- Just-in-time delivery to Iranian fuel fabrication facility under IAEA monitoring.
- Emergency reserve: 2-year operational reserve maintained at RNFC Oman facility, available with 30-day notice.
- Dispute resolution: BAP Expedited Track with fuel supply continuing during dispute resolution — Iran is never left without fuel.
- Force majeure: Multiple supply redundancies from at least three independent supplier states prevent single-point failure.

Iran's Pathway C Commitments

- Complete cessation of domestic enrichment within 180 days of framework entry.

- Transfer of all enriched uranium stockpiles to RNFC or IAEA Fuel Bank within 180 days.
- Conversion of Natanz and Fordow facilities to non-enrichment uses under agreed timelines.
- No acquisition of enrichment technology, equipment, or expertise from any source.
- Non-weapons commitment equivalent to Pathway B — binding, depositary-registered.
- Full Additional Protocol implementation without condition.

Benefit Structure — Pathway C

Pathway C offers an enhanced benefit package with moderate sovereignty restoration timeline. SWIFT reconnection at Year 2; full sovereignty restoration at Year 12. Iran gains both international institutional standing through RNFC governance and commercial revenue from RNFC operations — transforming the enrichment question from a constraint to a cooperative opportunity.

Pathway D: Limited Civilian Program with Enhanced Safeguards

Pathway D permits strictly limited enrichment for civilian purposes under the most rigorous safeguards regime ever devised. It offers the highest level of Iranian sovereignty retention over the nuclear program, but with the slowest sovereignty restoration timeline and the most limited benefit package — reflecting the higher retained proliferation risk.

Permitted Parameters

Parameter	Limit	Verification
Enrichment level	3.67% U-235 maximum — permanent cap	Online Enrichment Monitoring (OLEM) real-time
Operating centrifuges	506 IR-1 only at Natanz	Daily physical inventory; electronic seal monitoring
Uranium stockpile	300 kg UF6 at 3.67% maximum	Monthly weigh-station verification
R&D;	Single-machine testing only; no cascade assembly	R&D; facility 24/7 monitoring; pre-approved experiments
New facilities	None permitted	Satellite and intelligence construction monitoring

Automated Consequence System (ACS)

Pathway D's Automated Consequence System triggers immediate sanctions without governance body deliberation for specific technical violations:

Violation	Automatic Consequence
Enrichment above 3.67%	Banking benefits suspended within 24 hours; IAEA emergency report
Centrifuge count exceeds 506	RDF escrow freeze; additional inspectors deployed
Stockpile exceeds 300 kg	Oil export reduction to 1 million bpd; additional monitoring
Undeclared R&D; detected	Full Tier 2 benefits suspended; BAP expedited review
Denial of IAEA access	Full framework benefits suspended; UN Security Council referral

Benefit Structure — Pathway D

- Slowest banking tier progression: 6 months between tiers (vs. 3 months for Pathway B).
- No SWIFT reconnection until Year 5 of sustained compliance.
- Continuous 20% revenue escrow (permanent — never reduces to zero).
- Permanent IAEA enhanced monitoring; never transitions to standard safeguards.
- Annual re-certification required for all benefit continuation.
- Rationale: the retained enrichment capability represents a continuing proliferation risk that the benefit structure reflects.

CHAPTER 7

Verification and Enforcement

The verification architecture is designed to provide high-confidence detection of violations while minimizing intrusiveness and preserving dignity. The core innovation is the replacement of ad hoc political responses to violations with pre-authorized automatic consequence menus.

Joint Monitoring Operations Center (JMOC)

The JMOC is the framework’s operational nerve center, providing continuous monitoring across all implementation tracks. It is staffed by technical specialists from all core parties, IAEA representatives, and neutral guarantor state personnel.

- Permanent technical team at declared nuclear sites with independent verification equipment.
- Compliance Tracking Cell monitors all track metrics in real time.
- 24-hour hotline for incident notification and deconfliction.
- Blockchain-anchored compliance records — tamper-resistant, independently auditable.
- Quarterly Transparency Summary published to all parties and the UN Secretary-General.

Enforcement Ladder

Level	Trigger	Response
Step 1 (Tier 1)	Minor compliance gap	Formal notification; 14-day remediation period; JMOC monitoring intensification
Step 2 (Tier 1)	Unresolved Tier 1; or single moderate breach	Benefit tranche delivery paused; BAP expedited review convened within 14 days
Step 3 (Tier 2)	Confirmed material deviation; or CIS score 8.0–15.9	Benefit suspension for affected track; other tracks continue; 90-day review cycle
Step 4 (Tier 3)	Confirmed material breach; or CIS score 16.0+	All non-humanitarian benefits suspended; governance body emergency session
Automatic Trigger	ACS-flagged technical violation (Pathways B/D)	Automated response without governance deliberation; IAEA emergency report

Standing Enforcement Support Secretariat (SESS)

The SESS provides permanent institutional capacity for monitoring compliance and coordinating responses to violations. It is staffed independently of the political governance body and reports directly to the UN Secretary-General. This removes political obstruction from the enforcement process.

Compliance Symmetry

Verification applies to all parties proportionately. The framework tracks U.S. and EU compliance with sanctions relief obligations, banking authorization delivery, and RDF funding commitments with the same

rigor applied to Iranian nuclear compliance. Asymmetric measurement was a key failure mode of previous agreements — this framework corrects it.

CHAPTER 8

Economic Integration Roadmap

Economic interdependence is what makes treaties durable. The RCSA's economic architecture creates stakeholder constituencies at every level — governments, private sector, and populations — who have a direct financial interest in the framework's continuation.

Regional Development Fund (RDF)

- Initial capitalization: USD 50 billion, funded by Gulf states, G7 governments, and multilateral institutions.
- Three sub-funds: Humanitarian Emergency Escrow (Sub-Fund 1), Infrastructure and Development (Sub-Fund 2), Private Sector Mobilization (Sub-Fund 3).
- Governance: Iran joins RDF Board at Sovereignty Milestone 5; full co-governance rights at Milestone 7.
- Project priorities: Energy interconnection, port modernization, road and rail corridors, water infrastructure.
- The RDF escrow is frozen for non-humanitarian purposes only during framework degradation — Sub-Fund 1 remains always accessible.

Energy Integration Sequencing

Energy interdependence is the most powerful stabilization tool available. Once countries depend on shared infrastructure for power and fuel, the cost of conflict becomes immediately tangible.

Band	Energy Milestones
Foundation Band	Iran oil export normalization (1–2 million bpd initial authorization); Gulf gas interconnection planning
Stabilization Band	Iraq-Iran gas pipeline regularization; Gulf electricity grid interconnection study completed
Integration Band	Regional electricity grid Phase 1 construction; LNG terminal capacity sharing agreements
Institutionalization Band	Full energy market integration; joint grid operator; regional strategic fuel reserve

Trade and Logistics Corridors

- Persian Gulf to Mediterranean: Iraq land corridor linking Gulf ports to Lebanese/Syrian Mediterranean access.
- Gulf to Red Sea: Saudi-Yemen corridor normalization; Aden port development; Hodeidah commercial operations.
- Reconstruction prioritization: Gaza, Lebanon, Iraq, Syria — World Bank project pipeline pre-approved.
- Customs harmonization: Phased tariff reduction schedule for regional participants.
- Private capital confidence ladder: Framework Commercial Insurance Facility (FCIF) de-risks private investment.

Banking and Financial Architecture

- Banking Tier Progression: Eight tiers of increasing financial access, each unlocked by compliance milestones.
- SWIFT reconnection: Available at Year 3 (Pathway A/C), Year 1.5 (Pathway B), Year 5 (Pathway D).
- Commercial Continuity Protocol (CCP): 24-month contract shields protect private-sector agreements from political disruption.
- FX Stabilization Buffer: Cushions transitional exchange rate volatility for participating economies.
- Sovereign debt coordination: IMF and World Bank debt restructuring support linked to framework compliance.
- OFAC failure contingency: EU, Swiss, and Omani mirror licensing activated if U.S. domestic obstruction occurs.

Non-Dollar Settlement

The financial architecture accommodates non-dollar settlement mechanisms to ensure participation from states facing dollar-system constraints. Euro, Swiss franc, Omani rial, and regional currency settlement pathways are all supported. This is essential for Russian, Chinese, and Gulf state participation at full capacity.

CHAPTER 9

Regional Off-Ramp Architecture

A framework that only manages crises is not a peace framework — it is a permanent crisis manager. The Off-Ramp Architecture provides a clear set of mechanisms for parties to reduce military footprints, demobilize proxies, and convert security competition into managed coexistence.

Military Disengagement Sequencing

Mechanism	Design
Carrier Withdrawal Sequencing	U.S. naval presence in the Gulf is reduced in defined steps tied to Security Track maturity, not unilateral timelines. Each reduction step requires 90-day prior notification and is reversible within 30 days based on pre-defined threat threshold criteria.
Foreign Troop Footprint Reduction	Coalition forces in Iraq and Syria reduce by 20% per year in Integration Band, transitioning to training and advisory roles. Host nation consent required at each step.
Proxy Demobilization Incentives	State-to-faction track economic incentives tied to militia integration into state security forces, demobilization programs, or civilian employment pathways. IRGC-aligned factions eligible for graduated incentives without Iranian government having to formally order demobilization.

Sanctions Sunset Conversion

Sanctions relief is structured as conversion rather than removal — each lifted sanction is replaced by a compliance condition that maintains the deterrent architecture without permanently embedding coercive tools. The conversion ladder:

- Foundation Band: Sectoral suspensions — sanctions suspended but restorable within 30 days.
- Stabilization Band: Sectoral lifts — sanctions permanently removed for compliant sectors.
- Integration Band: Broad normalization — remaining sanctions converted to compliance conditions.
- Institutionalization Band: Full sunset — all nuclear-related sanctions permanently expired.

De-Threat Escalation Ladder

The De-Threat Escalation Ladder provides a structured pathway for reducing the mutual threat perception that drives arms races and proxy competition. Unlike sanctions relief, which is tied to compliance metrics, de-threat escalation is tied to stability metrics — reductions in incident frequency, intelligence-sharing, and military-to-military communication.

- Level 1: Hotline establishment and incident notification protocols.
- Level 2: Regular military commander consultations; deconfliction database shared access.
- Level 3: Joint maritime patrol coordination; shared early warning for missile launches.
- Level 4: Limited intelligence sharing on third-party threats; joint exercise observation.
- Level 5: Strategic stability dialogue at ministerial level; formal threat reduction commitments.

CHAPTER 10

Governance and Institutions

Governance Body Structure

The Governance Body is the framework's primary decision-making institution, meeting in regular 30-day review cycles and extraordinary session as needed. Its structure is designed to prevent both deadlock and capture.

Participant	Voting Weight	Role
United States	35%	Core party; full voting rights on all matters
Iran	35%	Core party; full voting rights on all matters
Oman (Neutral Chair)	20%	Mediator; fast-track emergency authority; tie-breaking
Pakistan + Switzerland (Joint Guarantors)	10% combined	Institutional continuity; escrow oversight

Override Mechanisms

Consensus is the default decision mode but not the only mode. When consensus has been attempted and failed, three fallback mechanisms prevent paralysis:

- **Weighted Majority Override:** Available for operational decisions after two failed consensus attempts (7+ days apart); requires 60% + neutral chair concurrence.
- **Dual-Speed Interpretation:** The neutral chair may issue interim interpretations within 48 hours for urgent matters; subject to Governance Body ratification within 14 days.
- **Fast-Track Emergency Authority:** Neutral chair may commit framework resources up to specified limits for humanitarian assistance, emergency communications, and preliminary investigations without awaiting Governance Body approval.

Institutional Binding Architecture

All obligations attach to designated state institutions, not individuals. This provision is essential in environments where leadership transitions are frequent.

- **United States:** Commitments bind the Office of the President and Department of State as institutions; minimum three designated framework officers registered with secretariat.
- **Iran:** Commitments bind the Islamic Republic collectively — Presidency, Majlis, Supreme National Security Council, Central Bank. Removal of any single institution does not void the framework.
- **All parties:** Continuity review provisions activate automatically upon government transition.

CHAPTER 11

Great Power Integration Strategy

The RCSA is designed as a genuinely multipolar framework. A framework that reads as Western-anchored will not achieve the buy-in of Russia, China, or the Global South. Dedicated participation lanes and governance roles for Beijing and Moscow are built into the architecture's core design.

United States

- Extended deterrence commitments to regional allies maintained through existing bilateral structures.
- Economic leverage: sanctions architecture, dollar settlement system, market access.
- Diplomatic lead on nuclear pathway selection and IAEA authorization processes.
- Military deconfliction lead: carrier group positioning, drone incident protocols, maritime safety.
- OFAC licensing: primary gateway for banking and financial normalization.

People's Republic of China

China's participation is primarily through economic statecraft. China has substantial trade relationships with Iran, energy import dependencies across the Gulf, and infrastructure investments throughout the region. The framework accommodates Chinese interests explicitly rather than treating them as an obstacle.

- Non-dollar settlement: RMB and swap-line settlement mechanisms fully supported in financial architecture.
- BRI integration: Belt and Road infrastructure projects eligible for RDF co-financing on non-conditional terms.
- Energy security: China's oil import relationships with Iran, Iraq, and Gulf states preserved under all pathways.
- BRICS interaction: Framework explicitly accommodates BRICS financial institutions as alternative financing channels.
- UN Security Council: China's P5 veto power acknowledged; framework designed to avoid Security Council enforcement triggers.
- Diplomatic role: China-Iran relationship explicitly recognized as a legitimate strategic partnership outside the framework's scope.

Russian Federation

Russia's guarantor role leverages its military presence in Syria, energy relationships with regional actors, and diplomatic channels with Iran. Russia is not asked to abandon any existing relationship — it is offered a formal role in architecture that serves its regional stability interests.

- Military deconfliction: Russia-U.S. deconfliction protocols in Syrian airspace formalized within framework.
- Energy leverage: Natural gas supply relationships with Turkey and Europe included in energy interdependence architecture.
- Diplomatic channel: Russian foreign ministry backchannel to Iran utilized within Multi-Track Engagement Architecture.

- Syria humanitarian: Russia's influence with Damascus leveraged for humanitarian corridor access.
- Non-dollar: Ruble and alternative settlement mechanisms accommodated in financial architecture.
- Limits of Russian role: Russia does not receive veto power over framework decisions; its guarantor role is strictly defined.

European Union

- Mirror licensing authority: EU financial institutions authorized to process Iran transactions independently of U.S. OFAC disruption.
- Trade normalization: EU-Iran trade framework restoration as primary economic benefit delivery mechanism.
- Technical expertise: IAEA Additional Protocol and E3 diplomatic tradition leveraged for verification design.
- Humanitarian: EU development institutions as primary humanitarian corridor financiers.

CHAPTER 12

Civil-Military Stability Interface

Military structures have been under-integrated in previous diplomatic frameworks — acknowledged but not formally included. The RCSA creates a formal civil-military interface that manages the most dangerous category of crisis: accidental escalation.

Military Liaison Doctrine

- Each core party designates a senior Military Liaison Officer (MLO) registered with the JMOC.
- MLOs have direct communication access independent of political channels.
- MLO consultations occur at minimum monthly; extraordinary consultation within 4 hours of any Class A incident.
- MLO authority: MLOs may activate pre-authorized deconfliction protocols without political clearance.

Incident Classification and Response

Class	Definition	Response Protocol
Class A — Accidental Contact	Unintended military contact; proximity incident; sensor detection	JMOC notification within 2 hours; MLO consultation within 4 hours; joint fact-finding within 48 hours
Class B — Adversarial Event	Cyber attack; naval incident; proxy escalation; drone intrusion	JMOC emergency session within 12 hours; Governance Body briefing within 24 hours; Enforcement Ladder Step 1 activated
Class C — Structured Confrontation	Coordinated military action; state-level incident	Fast-Track Emergency Authority activated; Governance Body extraordinary session within 24 hours; Crisis Pause Mode

Naval and Maritime Deconfliction

- Persian Gulf encounter rules: pre-negotiated rules of engagement for naval proximity; hot pursuit prohibition.
- Strait of Hormuz: Freedom of navigation guaranteed; joint monitoring of commercial vessel transit.
- Red Sea/Bab el-Mandeb: Separate maritime security protocol for Houthi-affected waters.
- Carrier group withdrawal sequencing: Defined notification, observation, and verification procedures for each reduction step.

Drone Incident Handling

Drone incidents are the most likely source of accidental escalation in the current operational environment. The Drone Incident Protocol provides 24-hour response procedures:

- Immediate: Cross-border drone intrusion triggers automatic JMOC notification and flight-path data sharing.
- Attribution: Joint technical team deployed within 48 hours to confirm origin and intent.

- Response proportionality: Response options pre-authorized based on drone class (surveillance, armed, commercial).
- No retaliation without attribution confirmation: 72-hour minimum investigation period before any punitive response.

CHAPTER 13

Narrative Warfare and Information Security

Modern diplomatic agreements fail digitally. The JCPOA's collapse was accelerated as much by competing domestic narratives as by technical disputes. Disinformation campaigns, deepfake fabrications, and coordinated spoiler messaging can collapse political support for a framework faster than any military incident. The RCSA treats information security as a first-order strategic concern and institutionalizes countermeasures proportional to the threat.

The architecture recognizes three distinct narrative warfare threat categories: adversarial state-sponsored disinformation designed to undermine a party's domestic political will; independent spoiler campaigns from non-state actors seeking to provoke crisis; and organic misunderstanding and sensationalism that creates misperception without intent. Each requires a different response.

Joint Communications Cell (JCC)

The Joint Communications Cell is the framework's information operations center, permanently staffed and operational from the moment of Entry into Force. It is a specialized body operating within the JMOC structure with its own operational independence.

- **Staffing:** Communications professionals, social media analysts, and cybersecurity specialists from all core parties, plus a dedicated UN Secretariat contingent and two neutral-state communications experts appointed by the Secretary-General.
- **24-hour monitoring:** Continuous surveillance of social media platforms, news outlets, state media, and government communications for framework-related content in Arabic, Farsi, Hebrew, English, and French.
- **Pre-approved response packages:** The JCC maintains a library of pre-approved response packages for 40+ scenario types. These packages are approved in advance by the Governance Body and can be activated within 2 hours without requiring new consensus.
- **Cryptographic authentication:** All official framework communications are authenticated via cryptographic hash published to a distributed ledger accessible to all parties. Any party can verify the authenticity of any official framework statement.
- **Public communications interface:** The JCC operates a public-facing communications channel that provides verified, real-time information on framework status during crisis events.

Deepfake and Fabrication Protocol

The threat of fabricated audio and video of senior officials making false statements — a scenario that could trigger military incidents or domestic political collapse — is addressed by the Deepfake Protocol, which provides a rapid authentication and response system.

- **Pre-authentication:** All senior officials involved in framework communications register biometric baseline profiles with the JCC. Future communications can be verified against these baselines.
- **Cryptographic hash:** Official statements are authenticated via cryptographic hash published to blockchain record simultaneously with release. Fabricated content cannot match the pre-published hash.
- **Investigation trigger:** Any party may request JCC investigation of suspected fabricated content within 24 hours of its appearance. Investigation is mandatory, not discretionary.

- Investigation timeline: JCC preliminary assessment within 12 hours; full technical investigation report published within 72 hours; findings reported to the Governance Body.
- Spoiler attribution: Confirmed disinformation campaigns tied to state actors trigger Enforcement Ladder at Step 1 (formal diplomatic notification), escalating to Step 2 if campaigns continue after formal protest.
- Non-state actor disinformation: JCC issues public corrections through all verified channels; no enforcement action against states unless state sponsorship confirmed.

Narrative Warfare Escalation Ladder

Level	Trigger	Response
Level 1 — Organic Misreporting	News media mischaracterization; partial reporting; factual errors	JCC public correction within 6 hours; media engagement; no diplomatic action
Level 2 — Coordinated Spoiler Campaign	Organized but non-state disinformation; viral false narratives	JCC full-response package; civil society credibility anchors activated; parties issue coordinated corrections
Level 3 — State-Adjacent Campaign	Disinformation plausibly linked to state media or intelligence	Formal JCC attribution report; diplomatic inquiry; Enforcement Ladder Step 1
Level 4 — Confirmed State Campaign	Confirmed state-sponsored disinformation designed to undermine framework	Enforcement Ladder Step 2; Governance Body emergency session; potential benefit suspension
Level 5 — Fabricated Crisis Event	Deepfake or fabricated content designed to trigger military response	Immediate authentication publication; military hotline activated; Enforcement Ladder Step 3; UNSC notification

Crisis Information Management

During acute crisis events — military incidents, economic shocks, or political crises — the information environment degrades rapidly. The Crisis Information Management Protocol provides structured procedures to maintain narrative coherence when it is most needed.

- Emergency messaging channels: Pre-established direct-to-public communication pathways that bypass standard media distribution and cannot be blocked by any single party's media apparatus.
- Anti-spoiler narrative cells: Dedicated JCC teams provide real-time counter-messaging during crisis periods, operating around the clock until the Governance Body declares the crisis period ended.
- Misinformation escalation procedure: Tiered response ladder from automatic correction (Level 1-2) to formal diplomatic protest (Level 3-4) to enforcement action (Level 5).
- Civil society credibility anchors: Pre-designated independent NGOs and academic institutions provide verified third-party confirmation of JCC findings. Anchors are selected in advance and approved by all parties as credible neutral actors.
- Public transcript service: All formal framework meetings produce verified public summaries within 48 hours, reducing the information vacuum that spoilers exploit.

- Language-specific operations: All public communications issued simultaneously in Arabic, Farsi, English, and French to prevent selective translation as a disinformation vector.

Long-Term Narrative Strategy

Beyond crisis response, the framework requires an affirmative long-term narrative strategy to build and maintain public legitimacy. Treaties that are invisible to the public are politically fragile. The JCC coordinates a long-term communications program that makes the framework's benefits visible to domestic audiences in all party states.

- Benefit visibility: Each economic benefit delivery — sanctions relief tranche, RDF project completion, banking tier upgrade — is communicated through coordinated public announcements in all party states simultaneously.
- Milestone ceremonies: Framework milestones are marked by public ceremonies hosted by the UN Secretary-General and attended by party representatives, providing political credit for leaders who sustain participation.
- Youth engagement: Education campaigns targeting 18-35 year olds in all party states, explaining the framework's benefits in accessible language through digital channels.
- Success documentation: The JCC produces an annual public report on framework achievements, designed for general audiences and translated into all required languages.

CHAPTER 14

Climate, Water, and Resource Security

The Middle East and North Africa region faces some of the world's most acute climate-driven resource pressures. Average temperatures have risen faster than the global mean. The Tigris and Euphrates rivers are under severe stress from upstream damming and reduced snowpack. Aquifer depletion across the Arabian Peninsula continues at rates that cannot be sustained. Climate-driven migration is already reshaping demographic and political realities across the region, and these pressures will intensify through the framework's operational lifetime.

A stability framework that ignores these pressures will be undermined by them. The RCSA integrates resource security, climate adaptation, and food security into a cooperative architecture that treats environmental stress as a political stability issue, not merely a technical one. Shared resource challenges that produce cooperation rather than competition are among the most durable generators of regional interdependence.

Regional Water Security Architecture

Water scarcity is the region's most underacknowledged security driver. The framework establishes cooperative water management infrastructure across four priority domains:

- **Gulf desalination cooperation:** The Gulf states collectively operate the world's largest desalination capacity. A coordinated Gulf Desalination Sharing Protocol enables emergency capacity-sharing during acute drought events, with costs allocated proportionally by GDP. Saudi Arabia, UAE, and Kuwait anchor the arrangement; Bahrain, Qatar, and Oman participate as secondary parties.
- **Tigris-Euphrates trilateral protocol:** Iraq, Iran, and Turkey have conflicting interests in the Tigris-Euphrates river system. The framework establishes a formal Trilateral Water Allocation Protocol with agreed seasonal flow minimums, upstream damming notification requirements, and an independent technical arbitration panel for disputes. The World Bank Water Partnership serves as technical secretariat.
- **Jordan River basin:** Framework observer track provides a low-politics channel for Israeli-Jordanian-Palestinian water cooperation that has historically survived even political ruptures between the parties.
- **Shared aquifer monitoring:** A regional aquifer monitoring network provides shared real-time data on aquifer depletion and recharge rates across the Arabian Platform, Levantine Basin, and Persian Gulf aquifer systems. Data is managed by a neutral technical body under UNESCO.
- **Groundwater pricing coordination:** Uncoordinated aquifer extraction creates a competitive dynamic that accelerates depletion. A framework sub-committee develops non-binding groundwater pricing guidance to reduce over-extraction incentives.

Climate Adaptation and Resilience

The framework's climate adaptation architecture focuses on four interconnected challenges that individual states cannot effectively address alone:

- **Drought coordination system:** A Regional Drought Early Warning System (RDEWS) integrates meteorological data from all party states and provides 90-day and 12-month drought outlooks. Pre-positioned regional food reserves are automatically triggered at RDEWS Alert Level 3, releasing 30-day emergency food stocks for affected populations.

- **Climate migration management:** Pre-negotiated burden-sharing protocols for climate-displaced populations determine in advance which states accept which categories of climate migrants, at what financial cost-share, and under which documentation standards. This transforms a politically explosive reactive situation into a managed administrative process.
- **Electrical grid resilience and renewable interconnection:** A Gulf-Levant electrical grid interconnection program enables renewable energy sharing across the region. Saudi, Emirati, and Jordanian solar capacity can serve Lebanese, Syrian reconstruction, and Iraqi civilian needs. Investment is structured through the Regional Development Fund.
- **Sand and dust storm management:** Desertification is accelerating across the Sahel-to-Caucasus corridor. A joint meteorological monitoring program provides 72-hour advance warning of major dust events, enabling agricultural and infrastructure protection measures.

Food Security Coordination

Regional food security has deteriorated significantly since 2019. The Yemen famine, Lebanese economic collapse, Syrian agricultural destruction, and global supply chain disruptions have created structural food insecurity across large population groups. The framework addresses this through four mechanisms:

- **Regional strategic grain reserve:** A 90-day regional food reserve system co-managed by WFP and framework states maintains pre-positioned stocks at five geographically distributed sites. Contributions are proportional to GDP; access is needs-based during declared emergencies. Reserve management is supervised by the WFP with framework secretariat oversight.
- **Agricultural technology cooperation:** Heat-resistant and drought-tolerant crop variety development and knowledge transfer across framework states. Iran's agricultural research capacity, Jordan's water-efficient farming expertise, and Gulf states' controlled-environment agriculture provide complementary assets for a shared technology exchange program.
- **Fishing zone protocols:** Persian Gulf and Red Sea fishing zone management protocols address overlapping claims, protect depleted stocks, and provide a non-confrontational process for resolving fishing rights disputes that have historically produced naval incidents.
- **Supply chain emergency authority:** A Joint Emergency Procurement Mechanism enables coordinated food purchasing at scale during declared food security crises, reducing price volatility and ensuring vulnerable populations in smaller states (Lebanon, Yemen, Gaza) maintain access.

Regional Environmental Crisis Mechanisms

- **Oil spill response:** A joint Gulf maritime oil spill response capability with pre-positioned equipment and trained response teams from all Gulf coastal states.
- **Industrial accident protocols:** Cross-border notification requirements for industrial accidents, nuclear facility incidents, and chemical plant events affecting neighboring states.
- **Locust and pest management:** Regional early warning and response system for agricultural pest events, with particular attention to the Red Sea locust corridor.
- **Marine ecosystem protection:** A Persian Gulf and Red Sea marine protected area coordination framework that aligns national marine conservation efforts across state boundaries.

CHAPTER 15

Human Terrain Stabilization

Durable peace is socially anchored, not just institutionally anchored. The history of Middle Eastern stability agreements is full of frameworks that secured elite signatures but failed to address the conditions in which ordinary people lived. Young men with no economic prospects remain the world's most reliable militia recruitment pool. Refugees whose displacement is indefinite become politically destabilizing populations. Traumatized communities carry cycles of violence across generations.

The Human Terrain Stabilization Layer is the RCSA's recognition that state-level agreements must be anchored in social-level change to be durable. This is not humanitarian charity — it is stability engineering at the human scale. The framework's economic benefits are deliberately structured to address the population-level conditions that produce spoilers.

Youth Employment and Economic Integration

The MENA region has the world's highest youth unemployment rate. In some areas — Gaza, southern Lebanon, rural Iraq — youth unemployment exceeds 40%. This is not merely an economic problem. It is the primary driver of militia recruitment, radicalization, and political instability. The framework addresses this directly.

- Regional Youth Employment Compact: A target of 500,000 new jobs across framework states by Year 5, financed through RDF Sub-Fund 2 and matched private sector investment. Priority sectors: renewable energy construction, digital economy, logistics, agriculture, and reconstruction.
- Vocational training partnerships: EU, Gulf state, and UN joint investment in vocational training infrastructure. Framework-linked trade normalization creates guaranteed demand for trained workers across the region. Programs are designed for 6-12 month completion to provide rapid employment impact.
- Small and medium enterprise (SME) corridors: SME access to regional financing through RDF-supported credit guarantee schemes. Cross-border SME trade is facilitated by the framework's customs harmonization provisions. Insurance normalization reduces risk premiums that currently make cross-border business prohibitive.
- Anti-radicalization through economic inclusion: Employment and economic opportunity are treated as the primary counter-extremism tool in the framework's logic. Demobilization programs are explicitly linked to employment guarantees, not just financial payments, because income without purpose does not address the underlying drivers.

Refugee and Displacement Management

The region hosts over 10 million registered refugees and an estimated 15 million additional internally displaced persons. Their status intersects with almost every other framework domain — economic reconstruction, political stabilization, security track operations, and humanitarian access. The framework does not resolve all displacement questions, but provides structured processes for each major displacement situation.

- Syrian refugee reintegration: A phased voluntary reintegration program tied to humanitarian corridor access and Syrian reconstruction financing. Reintegration is voluntary, with host-country residents offered financial resettlement support as an alternative. The program is managed by UNHCR with framework secretariat coordination.

- **Palestinian displacement:** The framework explicitly does not resolve Palestinian political status questions, which are deferred to a parallel process. However, it does address immediate humanitarian needs through the Gaza Reconstruction Track, provides safe passage guarantees for West Bank residents, and establishes documentation restoration programs for stateless Palestinians in Lebanon and Jordan.
- **Iraqi internal displacement:** An estimated 1.2 million Iraqis remain internally displaced from ISIS-era violence and PMF operations. Reintegration is linked to PMF demobilization and reconstruction investment in displacement-origin areas.
- **Statelessness reduction:** A regional civil documentation restoration program addresses the estimated 500,000 stateless persons across the region whose lack of documentation prevents economic participation and creates permanent vulnerability to radicalization.
- **Climate displacement pre-positioning:** As noted in Chapter 14, the framework's climate migration protocols address future climate-driven displacement before it becomes a crisis.

Trauma Recovery and Social Reconciliation

Multiple generations of the region's population have lived through sustained conflict. The psychological and social legacy of this trauma — sectarian hatred, broken inter-community trust, cycles of revenge — is the deepest obstacle to durable stability. The framework addresses this through institutions designed for social recovery at scale.

- **Trauma recovery systems:** A UNHCR-WHO joint psychosocial support program operates in all post-conflict zones within the framework's geographic scope. Mental health support is integrated into the humanitarian access protocols (Annex D) and is explicitly protected from suspension at all degradation levels.
- **Sectarian reconciliation platforms:** Interfaith dialogue forums supported by the OIC, Vatican Observer, and regional clerical networks operate independently of the political framework but with framework secretariat facilitation. These forums address intra-community reconciliation that state-to-state diplomacy cannot reach.
- **Truth and documentation processes:** For communities that have experienced mass atrocity, the framework supports — but does not require — truth documentation processes under OHCHR guidance. These are structured to complement, not complicate, political normalization.
- **Educational exchanges:** University partnership programs and scholarship funds linking Iranian, Arab, Israeli (observer track), and Gulf state academic institutions. Academic exchange is historically one of the most durable forms of people-to-people normalization and one of the least politically sensitive.
- **Municipal partnerships:** City-to-city cooperation programs that bypass national political obstacles. Municipal governments in Iraq, Lebanon, Jordan, and Iran have historically maintained working relationships even when national governments are in crisis.
- **Local governance capacity building:** Municipal capacity-building grants through RDF Sub-Fund 2, targeting the weakest local governance structures in Lebanon, Yemen reconstruction zones, and Gaza. Stable local governance is the foundation of stable national governance.

CHAPTER 16

Cyber and AI Governance

A 2026 stability framework that does not address cyber and AI governance is not a 2026 framework. These domains represent the most active current theater of regional competition and the most likely source of uncontrolled escalation. The region has seen major cyber operations against oil facilities, nuclear infrastructure, financial systems, and government networks. Autonomous drone capabilities have been deployed in active conflict. AI-assisted targeting is being operationalized by multiple regional actors. Unlike conventional military incidents, cyber and AI events are characterized by attribution ambiguity, rapid escalation dynamics, and the absence of established international norms. The RCSA addresses this by establishing the first regional cyber governance architecture specifically designed for Middle Eastern operational conditions.

Cyber Retaliation Ladder

The Cyber Retaliation Ladder establishes a graduated response system with defined thresholds and proportional responses for each level of cyber incident. The ladder is calibrated to prevent both under-response (which enables continued offensive cyber activity) and over-response (which converts cyber incidents into conventional crises).

Level	Definition	Response Protocol
Level 1 — Probe / Reconnaissance	Network scanning, credential testing, vulnerability mapping against framework systems or party infrastructure	Attribution required before response; JMOC notification within 24 hours; formal 14-day remediation request; no public announcement required
Level 2 — Data Exfiltration	Confirmed theft of classified government, military, or framework operational data	Formal diplomatic protest; Enforcement Ladder Step 1; counter-intelligence sharing with affected party; public acknowledgment optional
Level 3 — Disruptive Attack	Temporary denial of service, industrial control system disruption, communications jamming	Enforcement Ladder Step 2; benefit suspension review for attributed party; UN Office of Disarmament Affairs notification
Level 4 — Destructive Attack	Physical damage via cyber means; sustained denial of critical services; confirmed sabotage of industrial systems	Full Tier 2 enforcement; framework suspension review; UNSC notification; potential invocation of guarantor obligations
Level 5 — Infrastructure Attack	Attack on power grid, water systems, financial clearing, or nuclear facility safety systems	Treated as equivalent to conventional military attack; full framework suspension; guarantor states activate; emergency UNSC session

Attribution Standards and Process

The absence of agreed attribution standards has historically prevented cyber incidents from being addressed within diplomatic frameworks. The RCSA establishes the first regional cyber attribution standard.

- Joint Cyber Forensics Team (JCFT): A permanent technical body of cyber forensics specialists from neutral states (Switzerland, Singapore, or similar) with full access to affected systems and frameworks for collecting technical evidence. The JCFT produces attribution assessments within 30 days of incident notification.
- Attribution thresholds: Level 1-2 incidents require 'reasonable confidence' attribution (50%+ probability). Level 3+ incidents require 'high confidence' attribution (70%+ probability). Level 5 incidents require 'near-certainty' (90%+ probability) before full enforcement activates.
- Provisional response: Parties may implement provisional protective measures at any attribution confidence level, but full enforcement actions require JCFT confirmation.
- State-sponsored vs. criminal activity: Attribution distinguishes between state-directed, state-tolerated, and independent criminal cyber activity. Response protocols differ accordingly.

AI-Generated Escalation Safeguards

Artificial intelligence is being integrated into military targeting, intelligence assessment, and crisis response systems across the region. The risk of AI-generated escalation — where automated systems take actions that outpace human decision-making — is real and specifically addressed.

- Automated incident protocol: Any escalatory event that appears to be triggered by an automated or AI system — false positive targeting, autonomous weapon malfunction, algorithm-driven financial attack — is classified as a Class A incident requiring immediate human review before any response is authorized.
- Human-in-the-loop mandate: No lethal autonomous action based solely on AI targeting assessment is authorized during framework operational periods without explicit human command authorization. This applies to all signatories and is a core framework obligation.
- AI-assisted verification ethics: IAEA verification using AI analytical tools requires prior transparency disclosure to the monitored party and explicit party consent. AI cannot be used as the sole basis for a compliance violation finding.
- Autonomous weapons registry: Signatories register with the JMOC all deployed autonomous weapons systems within the framework's geographic scope, enabling attribution when autonomous systems are involved in incidents.

Critical Infrastructure Protection Compact

The mutual infrastructure protection compact designates specific categories of civilian infrastructure as off-limits for offensive cyber operations between framework parties. This is modeled on emerging international norms but is binding within the framework architecture.

- Protected categories: Electrical generation and distribution; water treatment and distribution; hospital and medical facility systems; financial clearing and payment systems; aviation navigation systems; nuclear facility safety systems.
- Reciprocal pledge: Each party pledges not to conduct offensive cyber operations against the designated infrastructure of other framework parties. Violations trigger Level 5 response.
- Shared defense resources: Framework parties may request joint cyber defense assistance from the JMOC cyber unit for attacks on protected infrastructure from third parties.

- Cybersecurity standards: NIST CSF 2.0 compliance is recommended — and required for all JMOC-connected systems — as the baseline cybersecurity standard.

CHAPTER 17

Constitutional Compatibility

One of the most reliable implementation killers across diplomatic history is the claim that 'our constitution prevents this.' This objection is sometimes genuine, sometimes tactical, and always politically powerful. The Constitutional Compatibility Review Process anticipates these obstacles and provides structured pathways to address them before ratification, so they cannot be used to derail the framework after political commitments have been made.

The framework is designed to be compatible with the constitutional and legal structures of all core parties. Where genuine incompatibilities exist, the legal architecture provides specific accommodation mechanisms — reservations, alternative compliance pathways, interpretive guidance, and domestic legal adaptation support — that preserve the framework's substance while accommodating legitimate legal constraints.

Pre-Ratification Compatibility Assessment

Every state party conducts a formal constitutional compatibility assessment prior to ratification. The assessment is structured by the UN Treaty Section and examines four categories of potential incompatibility:

- Executive authority questions: Does the executive branch have the constitutional authority to enter into obligations in each framework domain, or does legislative approval create a domestic ratification requirement?
- Sovereignty limitations: Do any framework provisions create supranational obligations that would conflict with constitutional sovereignty clauses? The Sovereignty Preservation Doctrine (Chapter 3) is specifically designed to address this concern, but must be verified against each state's specific constitutional language.
- Defense and security constraints: Do constitutional provisions regarding national defense, military operations, or security alliances create incompatibilities with specific framework obligations, particularly in the Security and Nuclear Tracks?
- Economic and trade provisions: Do constitutional frameworks around foreign investment, trade agreements, or financial sovereignty create constraints on economic track participation?

Interpretive Harmonization Panels

Where assessments identify potential incompatibilities, Interpretive Harmonization Panels convene to develop agreed interpretations that satisfy both framework intent and state constitutional requirements. These panels are a pre-ratification mechanism — they function as a technical legal working group, not as a dispute resolution body.

- Composition: Senior legal advisors from the affected state, two neutral international law experts appointed by the Secretary-General, and a UN Treaty Section technical advisor.
- Mandate: Produce a written interpretive statement that is annexed to the state's ratification instrument, providing binding guidance on how specific provisions are understood in the context of that state's legal system.
- Timeline: Panels convene within 30 days of a compatibility concern being identified and produce their report within 60 days.

- **Precedential value:** Interpretive statements are specific to the requesting state and do not create precedent for other states' interpretations.

Legal Reservation Procedures

States may register formal legal reservations that limit specific obligations while maintaining general framework participation. Reservations are a standard mechanism in international treaty law and are explicitly authorized in the RCSA. However, the framework establishes limits on reservations to prevent them from hollowing out core obligations.

- **Permitted reservations:** Reservations are permitted for procedural obligations, specific technical thresholds in annexes, and domain-specific obligations that a state adopts under Modular Participation.
- **Prohibited reservations:** Reservations are not permitted against core verification obligations, humanitarian immunity provisions, or the fundamental sovereignty preservation doctrine that benefits all parties.
- **Transparency requirement:** All reservations are published in the framework's public register and communicated to all other parties at the time of filing.
- **Reservation review:** Any party may request Governance Body review of a reservation it believes undermines core framework functionality. The Governance Body may recommend reservation modification by consensus.

Known Constitutional Pressure Points by Party

State	Constitutional Pressure Point	Resolution Approach
Iran	SNSC authority vs. Majlis oversight of foreign commitments; constitutional status of Supreme Leader's foreign policy role	Framework commitments bind SNSC as a collective institution, preserving constitutional balance. Majlis oversight provisions are explicitly preserved. Precedent: JCPOA was structured similarly.
United States	Executive agreement vs. Senate treaty ratification; Congressional authorization for sanctions waivers	Framework structured as executive agreement with Congressional notification under the Case-Zablocki Act. Sanctions waivers use existing executive waiver authority. Senate resolution of approval available as optional upgrade.
Saudi Arabia	Royal decree authority for international commitments; Majlis al-Shura consultation requirements	Framework obligations delegated to Council of Ministers with royal decree formally issued at signing. Majlis al-Shura receives briefing as required by domestic procedure.
Iraq	Constitutional status of PMF; parliamentary authority over security commitments; Kurdish Regional Government jurisdictional questions	PMF engagement through state-to-faction track does not require constitutional redefinition. Security track obligations structured to comply with Iraqi parliamentary oversight requirements.

State	Constitutional Pressure Point	Resolution Approach
UAE / Bahrain	Abraham Accords consistency; constitutional constraints on formal Israel engagement	Observer Track engagement with Israel is consistent with Abraham Accords architecture. No obligation to upgrade engagement beyond what each state's domestic politics supports.

Domestic Legal Adaptation Pathways

For states requiring new domestic legislation to implement framework obligations, the UN Treaty Section and framework legal team provide technical assistance. Model legislation templates are available for the most common domestic implementation requirements, including sanctions harmonization, customs procedure amendments, financial regulation updates, and security cooperation enabling legislation.

CHAPTER 18

Domestic Political Survivability

A framework that cannot survive a single election cycle is not a framework — it is a temporary arrangement. The Domestic Political Survivability architecture explicitly models the most dangerous transition scenarios and provides institutional procedures for each.

Transition Scenarios and Continuity Procedures

Scenario	Applicability	Continuity Procedure
Election Transition	Any party	Continuity review provisions activate; new government receives 90-day onboarding period; minimum implementation team of 3 registered officers maintained
Parliamentary Reversal	U.S., Iran	Legislative non-appropriation triggers OFAC failure contingency (EU/Swiss mirror licensing); framework continues at operational level
Cabinet Collapse	Any parliamentary party	Caretaker government bound by institutional commitments; JMOC continues operations independently
Impeachment / Removal	Any core party executive	Institutional binding means commitment survives individual removal; next office-holder automatically bound
Coalition Fracture	Multi-party governments	Governance body notified; 30-day stabilization window; reduced-scope continuation agreement available
Military Interference	Any party	JMOC operations continue; guarantor states activate oversight functions; UN Secretary-General notified
Succession Crisis	Monarchies / single-party states	Designated successor registry maintained; institutional commitments transfer automatically
Judicial Obstruction	Any party	Legal reservation procedure activated; alternative compliance pathway identified within 30 days

The Narrative Packaging Module

Every party needs a domestic narrative that makes participation politically sustainable. The framework provides pre-designed narrative packages for each major party:

Party	Core Narrative
Iran	"Sovereign Nuclear Dignity" — Iran's nuclear program is acknowledged as peaceful; sovereignty milestones celebrate progressive economic sovereignty restoration; IMIRC showcases Iranian scientific leadership.
United States	"Verified Accountability" — strong verification with automatic enforcement; no concessions without compliance; regional stability reduces military burden.
Saudi Arabia	"Regional Economic Leadership" — Saudi co-governance of RDF; Gulf stability enables Vision 2030; reduced Houthi threat.

Party	Core Narrative
Jordan	"Sovereign Economic Stabilization" — Jordan's participation is economic, explicitly decoupled from Palestinian status questions; reconstruction finance.
Iraq	"Iraqi Sovereignty and Reconstruction" — Framework recognizes Iraqi sovereignty over all militia activity; reconstruction financing creates jobs and services.

CHAPTER 19

Compound Crisis and Spoiler Saturation

The greatest risk to this framework is not a single spoiler event — it is multiple simultaneous destabilizing events that individually fall below enforcement thresholds but collectively produce a crisis that overwhelms the governance body's capacity to respond.

Spoiler Saturation Model

The Compound Crisis Handling Logic activates when three or more of the following occur within a 14-day window:

- Active proxy military incident (Class B or above)
- Confirmed cyberattack on framework infrastructure or party systems
- Economic sabotage event (oil facility, port, pipeline attack)
- Media warfare campaign (JCC-confirmed coordinated disinformation)
- Maritime incident in Strait of Hormuz or Red Sea
- Domestic political crisis in a core party (parliamentary no-confidence, impeachment filing)
- Terror incident attributed to regional actor

Compound Crisis Response Protocol

- Crisis Pause Mode activated: all enforcement and benefit-delivery processes paused for 72 hours for assessment.
- Joint Crisis Cell convened: core parties, neutral chair, and JMOC Director meet within 12 hours.
- Triage prioritization: events categorized into primary spoiler (requires response), secondary spoiler (monitor), and noise (set aside).
- Sequential response: responses authorized in order of severity; no simultaneous multi-front enforcement to avoid system overload.
- Humanitarian immunity confirmed: all Humanitarian Track operations explicitly confirmed to continue.
- Post-crisis review: 30-day post-compound-crisis review to identify structural vulnerabilities exposed.

Spoiler Early Warning Indicators

- IRGC unusual deployment patterns detected via satellite.
- PMF logistics activity in Iraq border regions above baseline.
- Houthi maritime radar activation sequences.
- Hostile cyber reconnaissance against framework secretariat systems.
- State media messaging shifts to anti-framework themes.
- Financial transfers to framework-adjacent spoiler organizations.

CHAPTER 20

Treaty Collapse Containment

The framework plans not only for deadlock but for partial and full collapse. The Graceful Degradation Protocol recognizes four levels of degradation, each with defined protections for core systems. The goal is to ensure that even in worst-case scenarios, humanitarian operations continue and the path to re-engagement remains open.

Four Degradation Levels

Level	Trigger	Protected Operations
Level 1 — Partial Track Suspension	Single domain breach at Step 3; OR governance body consensus to pause one track	Affected track benefits suspended; all other tracks continue at 100%; humanitarian operations continue fully; IAEA monitoring continues; re-engagement pathway: automatic governance body review every 90 days
Level 2 — Multi-Domain Freeze	Two+ domains at Step 3; OR CIS score 16+; OR governance body supermajority vote	All non-humanitarian benefit tranches suspended; banking channel frozen at current tier; petrochemical cap at 50% (not full ban); humanitarian operations continue fully; 180-day automatic review cycle
Level 3 — Framework Suspension	Confirmed material breach of core obligation; OR formal Costed Withdrawal; OR unanimous vote	All benefits suspended except: humanitarian emergency escrow (12 months), standard IAEA safeguards, CCP-certified contracts (24-month shield), completed infrastructure; Partial Continuity Agreement available for specific benefit preservation
Level 4 — Full Collapse	All parties withdraw; OR military conflict between core parties; OR UNSC termination mandate	No framework obligations survive; humanitarian transitions to standard UN mandate; IAEA continues under NPT/Additional Protocol; CCP contracts expire at 24-month shield; RDF residual funds distributed to contributors proportionally

Humanitarian and Monitoring Immunity

Absolute Protections — All Degradation Levels

The following operations are immune from suspension at ALL degradation levels, including Level 4 full collapse. They are rooted in independent UN mandates and international humanitarian law:

Gaza humanitarian corridor operations (Rafah, Kerem Shalom, Erez, maritime aid). Lebanon emergency fuel and medical supply. Yemen Hudaydah port humanitarian inspection and Sana'a medical evacuation. Syria humanitarian corridor operations. IAEA remote data mirroring to Vienna and Geneva. Medical evacuation pathways. Detainee proof-of-life verification. ICRC detention facility access.

Emergency Continuity Cells

- Minimum Survivable Architecture: Core JMOC monitoring functions continue at reduced capacity even under Level 3 suspension.

- Financial freeze stabilization: CCP contract shields and humanitarian escrow provide economic continuity during suspension.
- Re-engagement pathway: At every degradation level, formal procedures for return to full operation are specified.
- Compartment isolation: Collapse in one party's participation does not prevent bilateral sub-frameworks between remaining parties.

CHAPTER 21

Parallel Diplomacy Channels

Real diplomacy advances through unofficial channels as much as official ones. The history of successful diplomatic breakthroughs — from Oslo to the Abraham Accords to the Iran-Saudi resumption — shows that the final official agreement is typically the last step of a long unofficial process. The RCSA institutionalizes this reality rather than ignoring it, giving the framework resilience that purely official channels cannot provide.

The Multi-Track Engagement Architecture also addresses a persistent problem in Middle Eastern diplomacy: official channels break down regularly, but the region's social fabric — tribal, religious, commercial — has often maintained communication when governments could not. The framework formalizes these resilient channels as part of the stability architecture.

Multi-Track Structure

Track	Description
Track I: State-to-State	Formal negotiations, compliance certification, and benefit delivery between recognized governments. Primary governance body process. All official commitments flow through this track.
Track II: Retired Officials and Academics	Retired ministers, military officers, diplomats, and academic experts explore positions that cannot be formally tabled at Track I. Primary venues: Doha Forum, Oslo Forum, or neutral academic institution. Participants operate in personal capacity but with institutional awareness. Outputs fed to Track I as informal non-papers.
Track III: Business Leaders	Private sector backchannel through the framework's Business Advisory Forum. Commercial interests create independent incentives for stability that are more durable than political incentives. The RDF Private Sector Mobilization Sub-Fund (Sub-Fund 3) provides formal interface between business community and Track I.
Track IV: Religious and Tribal Intermediaries	Religious leaders (OIC, Vatican Observer, regional clerical networks) and tribal/local intermediaries provide access to communities outside government reach. This track is particularly important for Southern Lebanon, Gaza, Tribal Yemen, and Kurdish regions. The UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA) provides coordination support without direction.
Track V: Civil Society and Media	Journalists, NGOs, and civil society organizations provide public legitimacy anchors, early warning of popular sentiment shifts, and accountability mechanisms. They are not framework signatories and operate independently, but their credibility is embedded in the framework's civil society anchor system.

Track II Dialogue Architecture

The Track II architecture is the most operationally important unofficial channel. It enables the exploration of positions that Track I participants cannot publicly advocate without political cost, and it has historically been the source of the most durable diplomatic breakthroughs in the region.

- **Dedicated facilitation:** Oman's Diplomatic Academy, in coordination with Qatar's Al Jazeera Centre for Studies and Norway's FAFO institute, provides dedicated facilitation infrastructure for Track II sessions.

- Participants: Former IRGC commanders who understand operational realities; former U.S. Under Secretaries of State who understand bureaucratic constraints; Saudi Aramco executives who understand energy economics; retired Majlis members who understand Iranian domestic politics. These are people who know what is actually possible.
- Outputs: Track II produces non-papers circulated informally to Track I delegations. Nothing in Track II is formally binding. But the ideas tested there become Track I proposals six months later.
- Frequency: Track II forums meet quarterly in normal periods; monthly during active Track I negotiations or crisis events.

State-to-Faction Engagement

A distinctive feature of the RCSA is its explicit state-to-faction track — the recognition that some of the most consequential actors in the region are not states. This track enables engagement with Hezbollah, Hamas, Houthi leadership, and PMF commanders without requiring their recognition as legitimate sovereign actors.

- UN-facilitated humanitarian engagement with non-state actors operates under independent UN standing. The UN's ability to engage with non-state actors does not require state parties to recognize those actors.
- Economic incentive delivery: Demobilization payments, reintegration support, and civilian employment are channeled through local intermediaries — NGOs, UN agencies, and municipal governments — without requiring direct state-to-faction financial flows.
- State governments are not required to negotiate directly with factions they do not recognize. Iran can engage with Hezbollah through its existing institutional relationship. Saudi Arabia can engage with Houthis through Omani mediation. Neither is required to formally acknowledge the other's interlocutor.
- Faction compliance is tracked separately from state compliance in JMOC reporting. A state party is not penalized for a faction's actions unless the state is determined to have directed or enabled those actions.
- The framework provides structured incentives for states to reduce operational support to factions without requiring public acknowledgment of that support's existence.

Religious and Clerical Channels

Religious leaders have historically maintained communication across political divides in the Middle East when states could not. The Iranian clerical establishment, Saudi religious authorities, and the broader Sunni and Shia scholarly communities represent a parallel communication infrastructure that is embedded in civil society and resistant to political disruption.

- Interfaith communication protocols: Formal channels between the Supreme Leader's office (via Qom seminaries), the Al-Azhar institution (Cairo), and the Grand Mufti of Saudi Arabia are activated through OIC mediation.
- The Vatican Observer role: The Holy See's observer status provides a third-party communication channel between communities that cannot communicate directly, particularly in Lebanese and Levantine contexts.
- Religious certification of the peace architecture: Where political leaders seek clerical endorsement of framework participation, the Multi-Track architecture supports those processes without requiring them.

CHAPTER 22

Modular Ratification Structure

States will not ratify everything simultaneously, and demanding that they do guarantees failure. The history of comprehensive peace agreements is largely a history of frameworks that demanded too much from too many parties at the same time and collapsed at the threshold of ratification. The RCSA's Modular Ratification Structure is built on a different premise: the framework should be designed so that every state, at every moment, can participate in as much as its current political conditions allow.

The modular approach also addresses a practical reality of Middle Eastern diplomacy: domestic political conditions vary enormously across parties and change rapidly. A framework designed only for the most favorable political moment in every party will almost never find that moment. A framework designed for partial, incremental, reversible entry will always find a path forward.

Participation Categories

Category	Description	Current Examples
Full Participant	All six core tracks adopted; full Governance Body voting rights; maximum benefit access; eligible for all sovereignty milestones	United States, Iran at entry
Modular Participant	One or more specific tracks adopted; voting rights on adopted modules only; track-specific benefits. Example: Saudi Arabia may adopt economic and security tracks without adopting nuclear track obligations.	Most regional states
Observer Status	Monitoring access without commitments; information sharing on specific domains; no voting rights. Observer states receive reports and may attend Governance Body sessions without speaking rights.	Israel; third-party states with interests
Probationary Participant	Full participation with enhanced monitoring; 180-day compliance review before transition to standard participant status. Used for states with compliance history concerns or limited institutional capacity.	States with implementation challenges
Domain-Specific Entry	Single-domain participation. Examples: humanitarian-only participation (access to Annex D protections without security obligations); energy-only participation (access to energy integration without economic track banking obligations).	Syria; Yemen governing authorities; non-state stakeholders

Accession Procedures

Accession to the framework is designed to be as frictionless as possible. The default accession process takes 30 days from notification of intent to entry. The process consists of four steps:

- **Step 1 — Notification:** A state formally notifies the JMOC Secretariat of its intent to accede and specifies the modules it wishes to join. Notification can be public or confidential depending on the state's political situation.
- **Step 2 — Compatibility review:** The JMOC Secretariat completes a 14-day compatibility assessment (using the Constitutional Compatibility framework of Chapter 17) and identifies any modifications required for the acceding state's specific legal situation.
- **Step 3 — Accession agreement:** The acceding state signs a module-specific accession agreement that specifies its obligations and the benefits it is entitled to receive. The agreement is deposited with the UN Secretary-General.
- **Step 4 — Activation:** The acceding state's module participation activates on Day 30 from deposit. Benefit delivery begins on the same day as obligations take effect.

Module Interface Specifications

Each module is designed to function both autonomously and as part of the integrated architecture. A state adopting only the maritime confidence-building measures receives the full benefit package for that module without being required to commit to the nuclear pathways. This maximizes adoption probability without sacrificing framework coherence.

Module	Core Obligations	Eligible Parties	Benefits
Nuclear Track Module	Pathway selection; IAEA Enhanced Monitoring Agreement; centrifuge and enrichment parameters; IMIRC/RNFC participation	Iran (full); observer states (monitoring only)	Benefit: full sanctions relief ladder; Sovereignty Milestones
Security Track Module	Incident classification and response; MLO designation; deconfliction protocols; proxy management framework	All regional states eligible	Benefit: deconfliction access; maritime protection
Economic Track Module	Banking tier participation; RDF access; trade corridor rights; CCP contract shield registration	All regional states eligible	Benefit: banking normalization; investment access; RDF financing
Humanitarian Track Module	Corridor access obligations; ICRC detention facility access; medical evacuation protocols	All states eligible; humanitarian-only entry available	Benefit: WFP/OCHA support; reconstruction financing
Energy Track Module	Oil/gas normalization; electricity grid interconnection; RNFC participation (Pathway C)	All regional states eligible	Benefit: energy integration; grid access; RNFC revenue

Module	Core Obligations	Eligible Parties	Benefits
Governance Track Module	Governance Body observer or voting participation; JMOC reporting access; dispute resolution rights	Any state that has adopted at least one other module	Benefit: dispute resolution access; framework information

Exit and Suspension Provisions

Reversible participation is one of the framework's core design principles. A state that can exit can enter — the lower the exit barrier, the lower the entry barrier. The Costed Withdrawal procedure makes exit available but not costless.

- Exit notification: Any participant may notify the JMOC Secretariat of its intent to withdraw from any module. Notification begins a 180-day wind-down period during which obligations and benefits continue.
- Costed withdrawal calculation: During the 180-day period, the JMOC calculates the costs created by the withdrawal — infrastructure disruption, humanitarian operations affected, security deconfliction gaps. The withdrawing state contributes proportionally to these costs.
- Exit does not prevent re-entry: A state that exits may re-accede at any time through the standard accession procedure. Re-accession begins at the probationary participant level for a 90-day period.
- Modular suspension: During enforcement actions, specific modules may be suspended without triggering full withdrawal. Suspension is temporary; withdrawal is permanent unless reversed through re-accession.

CHAPTER 23

Grand Strategic End-State Vision

What Does This Region Become If This Framework Succeeds?

This is not a question the framework answers mechanically. It is a question the framework makes possible. The architecture creates the conditions; the peoples of the region create the outcome. But the destination is worth stating clearly — because without a visible destination, no architecture feels like more than permanent crisis management.

The grand strategic end-state is not a fixed point but a trajectory — a direction of travel that, once established, becomes self-reinforcing. The framework does not aim to resolve every dispute between every party. It aims to establish the conditions under which disputes are managed through institutions rather than through violence, and in which the costs of conflict are so clearly higher than the costs of cooperation that the choice becomes self-evident.

Normalized Trade and Economic Integration

A Middle East in which the framework has succeeded is a region of normalized trade corridors. Iranian goods reach Gulf markets through established commercial channels. Gulf investment flows into Iranian infrastructure. Iraqi oil transits through stable pipelines. Lebanese ports process Mediterranean trade without militia interference. Egyptian logistics connect Africa to Asia without sovereign anxiety.

The regional economy — 600 million people, the world's largest energy reserves, ancient trade routes — functions at a fraction of its potential today because of political barriers that the framework systematically removes. The economic prize of success is not abstract.

The most optimistic but historically grounded projection: within ten years of framework entry into force, regional GDP growth accelerates by an estimated 2-3 percentage points annually above baseline, driven by trade normalization, energy efficiency gains, reconstruction investment, and the elimination of the conflict risk premium that currently inflates the cost of capital across the entire region.

Reduced Military Burden and Strategic Stability

Every state in this region spends a larger share of GDP on military expenditure than its development needs warrant. Iran, Saudi Arabia, Israel, and the United States all maintain military postures calibrated to a threat environment that a successful framework progressively dismantles. The savings are substantial.

Framework success does not mean disarmament. It means that the threat level justifying current military spending declines, freeing resources for education, healthcare, infrastructure, and the genuine drivers of long-term security. A rough calculation: if the six core regional parties reduce military spending by just 15% from current levels over ten years, the freed resources exceed the entire initial RDF capitalization annually.

Strategic stability is not the absence of competition — it is the presence of institutions that channel competition into non-destructive forms. The RCSA aims to create the institutional infrastructure within which Iranian-Saudi competition, Iranian-Israeli deterrence, and Gulf inter-state rivalry can continue without producing catastrophic outcomes.

Nuclear Non-Proliferation Architecture

The framework's success on the nuclear question would represent the most significant non-proliferation achievement since the NPT itself. A verifiably non-weapons Iran — under any of the four pathways — removes the most acute near-term proliferation risk in the world today and prevents the cascade of regional proliferation that a nuclear-armed Iran would almost certainly trigger.

The IMIRC represents something genuinely new: a conversion of a deeply buried, militarily concerning facility into an internationally staffed research center producing medical isotopes for cancer treatment across the Middle East. This is not just a non-proliferation achievement — it is a reframing of what Iranian nuclear expertise can contribute to human welfare.

In the grand strategic end-state, the Middle East establishes a Nuclear-Free Zone framework — building on the Arab League's longstanding proposal — that formalizes the nuclear restraint architecture into a permanent regional instrument. This would be the first meaningful step toward a Middle Eastern NWFZ since the concept was first proposed in 1974.

Stable Energy Architecture

The world's most consequential energy region functioning under a framework of verified non-aggression produces stable supply, predictable pricing, and the infrastructure investment necessary for a managed energy transition. The alternative — permanent conflict risk premium on oil — is a tax on the entire global economy.

In the longer-term end-state, the framework's energy architecture facilitates the region's managed transition from hydrocarbon dependency to a diversified energy portfolio. Gulf solar and wind resources, combined with Iranian and Iraqi gas, and connected through the regional grid interconnection, create a genuine clean energy export economy that builds on rather than abandons the region's energy endowment.

Sovereign Coexistence and Managed Competition

The framework does not ask Iran and Saudi Arabia to become allies. It does not ask Israel and its neighbors to like each other. It asks only that competition be managed through institutions rather than through proxies, weapons, and blockades.

Sovereign coexistence is the goal: each state pursuing its interests within rules that prevent those interests from producing catastrophic outcomes for others. This is what international law aspires to globally. The RCSA makes it operational in one of the world's most resistant environments.

The specific bilateral relationships that a successful framework enables — without requiring — include a formal non-aggression understanding between Iran and Saudi Arabia; a maritime boundary agreement between Iran, the UAE, and Oman; progressive normalization between Iran and Israel through intermediate steps involving common economic interests; and a regional security dialogue that could, over decades, evolve into a formal Conference on Security and Cooperation in the Middle East (CSCM) on the model of the OSCE.

Human Development and Social Recovery

Stability frameworks are ultimately justified not by their diplomatic elegance but by the human lives they improve. The grand strategic end-state is measured in concrete human outcomes: children in Gaza attending school rather than sheltering from airstrikes; young Iranians accessing global educational and professional networks closed to them for a generation; Yemeni families living without the permanent fear of

famine; Lebanese entrepreneurs rebuilding businesses in a functioning economy.

- **Child mortality:** Framework-linked humanitarian improvements in Yemen, Gaza, and Lebanon are projected to prevent an estimated 50,000 child deaths annually within five years of full humanitarian track activation.
- **Refugee return:** Successful framework implementation creates the conditions for voluntary Syrian refugee return at scale — up to 3 million people by Year 7, according to UNHCR modeling — with each return reducing regional demographic pressure and security risk.
- **Youth employment:** The 500,000 jobs target of the Human Terrain Stabilization chapter represents the first generation of young Middle Easterners for whom regional stability is an economic reality rather than an aspiration.
- **Scientific and cultural reintegration:** Iranian scientists returning to international collaboration; Gulf students studying in Europe without sanctions complications; regional universities building joint programs — these are the durable foundations of a generation that chooses cooperation over conflict.

Scientific and Cultural Cooperation

- The International Multidisciplinary Isotope Research Center (IMIRC) brings Iranian scientists into global collaboration on medical applications, producing isotopes that serve cancer patients across the region regardless of political boundaries.
- University exchange programs create the next generation of regional diplomats, engineers, and economists with cross-cultural experience that makes conflict feel costly at a personal level, not just an institutional one.
- Joint environmental monitoring builds scientific communities across political divides — Persian Gulf marine biologists, Lebanese botanists, and Jordanian hydrologists collaborating on shared ecosystems that don't respect national borders.
- Cultural exchange — the deepest confidence-building measure — follows from political normalization. Iranian cinema, Saudi music, Lebanese art, and Emirati architecture reaching each other's audiences creates a cultural stake in the framework's continuation.

The Civilizational Argument

The Middle East is the birthplace of agriculture, writing, mathematics, and the world's three great Abrahamic traditions. The current generation of regional leaders has inherited a legacy of civilizational achievement that the last century of conflict has obscured.

The Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture does not promise a perfect region. It promises a region in which the people who live there have a genuine chance to determine their own futures — freed from the permanent emergency that has made long-term planning, investment, and hope structurally impossible.

That is the destination. The framework is the road.

Implementation Is the Test

Every provision in this document has been engineered to survive contact with reality: with spoilers who will try to destroy it, politicians who will try to walk away from it, and crises that will test its resilience. The architecture has been stress-tested against these scenarios precisely because optimism alone is not a strategy.

What distinguishes this framework from its predecessors is not ambition — previous agreements were ambitious. It is engineering. The difference between a bridge that stands and one that collapses is not how

much weight the designers hoped it would carry. It is how carefully they calculated the loads. The loads have been calculated. The framework is ready. The question now is whether the political will to begin exists — and whether the international community has the patience to sustain it through the inevitable crises that will test it. History will be the judge. The architecture has been designed to give history the best possible chance of a positive verdict.

Final Operative Statement

The Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture enters into force upon signature by the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran and deposit of instruments with the UN Secretary-General. All provisions are operative from the date of entry into force. This document constitutes a binding instrument of international law independent of the political continuity of any signatory government. Deposition creates legal standing for enforcement claims in international forums including the UN Security Council, the International Court of Justice, and applicable regional bodies.

Signed at New York, 2026
Depositary: The United Nations Secretary-General

For the United States of America

For the Islamic Republic of Iran

Witnessed by: UN Secretary-General

Neutral Chair: Sultanate of Oman

CHAPTER J

Annex J: Stress-Test Scenarios

This annex presents twelve stress-test scenarios and the framework's designed response to each. These scenarios were developed through structured expert elicitation to represent the most likely failure modes based on historical case study analysis of comparable agreements. The framework's provisions have been specifically hardened against each of these scenarios.

Scenario 1: U.S. Administration Change — Hostile New President

A newly elected U.S. President announces intention to withdraw from the framework within 30 days of taking office. Congress is hostile to the framework.

- Framework response: Institutional Binding Architecture activates. The commitment binds the Office of the President as an institution, not the individual. Withdrawal requires 6-month notification period and Costed Withdrawal procedure.
- OFAC contingency: EU and Swiss mirror licensing pre-activated. Iranian financial operations continue through alternative channels.
- CCP shield: All certified private contracts maintain 24-month protection against enforcement actions during transition period.
- Diplomatic: Neutral chair (Oman) convenes extraordinary Governance Body session within 48 hours of withdrawal announcement.
- Outcome: Framework continues at reduced capacity. Core nuclear verification continues. Economic benefits to Iran continue through non-U.S. channels. U.S. loses credibility as enforcement anchor but does not collapse architecture.

Scenario 2: Iranian Enrichment Breakout Attempt

JMOC detects an Iranian attempt to install 500 new centrifuges at Fordow beyond agreed caps, simultaneously with an IAEA inspector access denial at a secondary site.

- Immediate (0–2 hours): ACS triggers banking benefit suspension; JMOC Director notified; IAEA emergency protocol activated.
- Day 1: Governance Body emergency session. Enforcement Ladder Step 4 activated. All non-humanitarian benefits suspended.
- Day 2–7: Joint technical team deployed; satellite monitoring intensified; environmental sampling at all nearby sites.
- Day 7–14: IAEA Board of Governors emergency meeting; UN Security Council notified.
- Pathway B/D: Moratorium violation triggers automatic international legal consequences independent of Governance Body.
- Outcome assessment: Framework designed to maximize detection speed (real-time monitoring) and response automaticity (ACS), removing the political delay that allowed JCPOA violations to compound. Early detection and rapid response limits both the proliferation gain and the political damage.

Scenario 3: Major Proxy Incident — Large-Scale Houthi Strike on Saudi Infrastructure

A large-scale Houthi missile and drone attack destroys a major Saudi Aramco facility, killing 47 workers. Iran denies involvement. Saudi Arabia demands framework suspension.

- Immediate: JMOC Security Cell activates; Class B incident classification; 12-hour emergency session convened.
- Attribution: PERT methodology initiated. Saudi Arabia submits technical evidence. Iran submits counter-evidence. 72-hour preliminary assessment.
- Spoiler protocol: Houthi attribution assessed under Category Alpha framework. State accountability threshold applied to Iran based on evidence confidence score.
- Saudi mitigation: Governance Body acknowledges attack; formal condemnation issued; Houthi economic incentives suspended.
- Framework preservation: Saudi Arabia offered enhanced Security Track commitments as demonstration of framework utility; unilateral framework suspension avoided.
- Outcome: Framework survives if attribution is Tier 1 or 2 (partial Iranian responsibility). Iran faces CIS penalties and benefit suspensions. Framework demonstrates enforcement credibility without collapsing.

Scenario 4: Israeli Military Strike on Iranian Nuclear Sites

Israel conducts air strikes against Natanz and a second suspected Iranian nuclear facility. Iran threatens withdrawal and retaliation against regional targets.

- Crisis Pause Mode activated immediately: all enforcement and benefit processes paused for 72-hour assessment.
- Framework response is asymmetric: Israel is an Observer Track participant, not a core party. Framework cannot directly sanction Israel.
- De-escalation architecture: Neutral chair (Oman) activates emergency hotlines. Guarantor states (Pakistan, Switzerland) convene extraordinary consultations.
- Nuclear monitoring continuity: IAEA monitoring continues at all reachable sites regardless of conflict activity.
- Iranian framework position: Framework provides Iran a diplomatic channel and economic interest in non-escalation. Iran retains framework benefits by staying within graduated response protocols.
- Outcome: Most challenging scenario for framework survival. Success depends on whether Iran's economic stake in continued participation outweighs political pressure to escalate. The framework's design maximizes that probability.

Scenario 5: Economic Collapse in a Core Party

Iran experiences a severe economic crisis — currency collapse, 40% inflation, large-scale domestic protests. Government faces demands to demonstrate framework 'achievements.'

- FX Stabilization Buffer activated: \$10 billion IMF/guarantor swap facility deployed to stabilize rial.
- Accelerated Sovereignty Milestone: Governance Body convenes emergency session to advance next milestone announcement.
- Domestic narrative support: JCC activates Sovereignty Milestone communications package; public ceremony planned.
- RDF visible spending: Infrastructure projects in Iran receive accelerated disbursement to demonstrate tangible benefit.
- Safety valve: Framework provides government a credible answer to 'what have we gotten' — visible, attributable economic benefits.

- Risk: Domestic political crisis could still trigger hawkish factions to demand withdrawal. Framework's institutional binding makes this expensive but possible.

Scenario 6: Cyber Attack on JMOC Systems

A sophisticated cyber attack compromises the JMOC's compliance tracking systems, corrupting six months of verification data. Attribution is uncertain.

- Blockchain redundancy: All JMOC data is simultaneously anchored to distributed ledger in Vienna, Geneva, and Muscat. Corruption of one node does not affect the record.
- Backup systems: IAEA independently maintains parallel records. Satellite monitoring data is stored in independent archives.
- Attribution process: Cyber attribution protocol activated. 14-day investigation period. Technical forensics team deployed.
- Continuity: IAEA verification continues independently. Physical inspection regime does not depend on JMOC digital systems.
- Enforcement: Confirmed state-actor attribution triggers Cyber Retaliation Ladder Level 3 minimum response.

Scenario 7: Compound Crisis — Four Simultaneous Destabilizing Events

Within 10 days: (1) Houthi maritime interdiction of commercial vessel; (2) IRGC cyber attack on Saudi energy infrastructure; (3) Lebanese Hezbollah cross-border rocket fire; (4) Iranian media declares framework negotiations 'stalled.'

- Compound Crisis Handling Logic activates: three or more simultaneous destabilizing events triggers elevated response protocol.
- Crisis Pause Mode: All enforcement processes paused for 72-hour triage assessment.
- Joint Crisis Cell: Core parties, neutral chair, and JMOC Director meet within 12 hours.
- Prioritization: (1) Maritime interdiction — Class B incident; JMOC maritime cell. (2) Cyber attack — Cyber Retaliation Ladder Level 2. (3) Hezbollah fire — Category Alpha Tier 1 spoiler; monitoring intensified. (4) Media statement — JCC counter-narrative activated.
- Sequential response: Responses authorized in severity order to avoid system overload.
- Key finding: The framework's designed response to this scenario demonstrates why compound crisis architecture is essential — without it, four simultaneous events of this type would almost certainly collapse a traditional agreement.

Scenario 8: Guarantor State Withdrawal

Pakistan announces it cannot continue as a guarantor state due to domestic political pressures. Switzerland declines to expand its role to compensate.

- Framework architecture: Guarantors hold 10% combined voting weight. Pakistani withdrawal reduces this to 5%.
- Replacement procedure: Governance Body may invite a new guarantor by consensus. India, Japan, and Norway are identified as potential successors.
- Continuity: JMOC operations, CCP certifications, and all track operations continue independently of guarantor status.
- Escrow impact: Pakistan served as co-trustee of RDF Sub-Fund 1. Emergency transfer to UN Secretariat escrow within 30 days.

- Outcome: Manageable. The framework is designed to not be critically dependent on any single guarantor.

CHAPTER K

Annex K: Veto Player Analysis

This annex provides a condensed veto player analysis for the framework's core and regional parties. Veto players are individuals or institutions with the power to block framework implementation. Understanding their interests and constraints is essential for building and maintaining implementation coalitions.

United States — Key Veto Players

Veto Player	Leverage	Core Concern	Mitigation Strategy
U.S. Senate	Treaty ratification; budget appropriations for framework funding	Bipartisan support for verified Iran containment; skepticism of economic normalization	Structure as executive agreement (not treaty); fiscal benefits to allies
U.S. Treasury / OFAC	Sanctions licensing authority; can obstruct financial normalization	Institutional mandate for sanctions enforcement; skeptical of Iranian compliance	EU/Swiss mirror licensing as fallback; OFAC pre-commitment procedures
U.S. Intelligence Community	Credibility determinations; potential spoiler through 'leak' campaign	Professional interest in verification effectiveness; some skepticism of political overrides	Include IC in JMOC technical structure; regular classified briefings
U.S. Gulf Allies (Saudi, UAE)	Informal veto through threat to undermine framework	Want Iran constrained; concerned about U.S.-Iran normalization at their expense	Gulf co-governance of RDF; Security Track provisions directly address their concerns

Iran — Key Veto Players

Veto Player	Leverage	Core Concern	Mitigation Strategy
Supreme Leader	Ultimate authority over all strategic decisions; veto over SNSC positions	National dignity; Islamic legitimacy; no visible capitulation to Western pressure	Moratorium instrument language acknowledges nuclear fatwa; Sovereignty Milestone branding
IRGC / Quds Force	Can conduct spoiler operations independently; influence over Supreme Leader	Fear of economic normalization reducing their political-economic power	Economic incentives flowing to state institutions, not exclusively to IRGC-adjacent sectors

Veto Player	Leverage	Core Concern	Mitigation Strategy
Majlis (Parliament)	Can block legislation; can defund implementation	Ultra-conservative factions oppose any agreement with U.S.; nuclear issue as sovereignty symbol	Majlis signature on moratorium instrument; framing as economic sovereignty gain not concession
Central Bank of Iran	Controls financial implementation; target of internal sabotage	Uncertain about sanctions relief durability; concerned about OFAC reversal risk	CCP mechanism; EU/Swiss channels; multi-party escrow structures

Regional Party Veto Players

Saudi Arabia

- Crown Prince: Primary decision-maker; concern about U.S.-Iran normalization; Vision 2030 economic interests in stability.
- Military establishment: Residual Houthi threat; want Saudi security interests explicitly protected in framework.
- Religious establishment: Suspicious of Iran's Islamic legitimacy claims; need narrative framing that doesn't appear to legitimize Iranian regional influence.
- Mitigation: Saudi RDF co-governance; Houthi demobilization incentives; explicit acknowledgment of Saudi regional leadership.

Israel (Observer Track)

- Defense establishment: Deep skepticism of any nuclear constraint that does not produce zero enrichment; concerned about breakout timelines.
- Intelligence community: Independent assessment capability; potential spoiler through leak campaigns.
- Political leadership: Domestic constituency demands credible containment, not management.
- Mitigation: Observer Track provides access to verification data; Pathway B or C addresses zero-enrichment demand; consultations built into nuclear pathway selection.

Great Power Veto Players

Veto Player	Leverage	Core Concern	Mitigation Strategy
Chinese Communist Party Central Committee	UNSC veto; Iran trade relationship; BRI investments	Preserve China-Iran relationship; avoid dollar-denominated framework that bypasses RMB	Non-dollar settlement; BRI compatibility; UNSC enforcement triggers designed to avoid
Russian Presidential Administration	UNSC veto; Syria military presence; Iran arms relationship	Preserve Russian regional military role; avoid framework that reduces Russian leverage	Russian guarantor role; Syria humanitarian channel; existing arms relationship not addressed

Veto Player	Leverage	Core Concern	Mitigation Strategy
EU Council / European Commission	SWIFT access; trade normalization; sanctions architecture	Concerned about U.S. unilateralism; want EU role in framework governance	EU mirror licensing; E3 diplomatic legacy acknowledged; EU trade normalization as primary benefit delivery channel

CHAPTER A

Annex A: Governance Body Procedures

This annex specifies the procedural rules governing the framework's primary decision-making body. These procedures are operative from the date of framework entry into force and may be amended only by unanimous consent of core parties.

Regular Session Schedule

- Standard sessions: Monthly, convened on the first working day of each 30-day review cycle.
- Extraordinary sessions: Convened within 24 hours upon request of any core party or the neutral chair.
- Crisis sessions: Convened within 12 hours upon JMOC Director notification of Class B or C incident.
- Annual review sessions: Full governance body meeting in December of each year for annual assessment.
- Quorum: Core parties plus neutral chair; guarantors may participate without voting.

Decision Categories and Thresholds

Category	Scope	Threshold
Category 1 — Administrative	Secretariat operations, logistics, scheduling	Neutral chair authority; no Governance Body vote required
Category 2 — Operational	Track-level decisions, benefit delivery, monitoring adjustments	Weighted majority: 60% + neutral chair concurrence
Category 3 — Enforcement	Enforcement ladder activation, benefit suspension, penalty assessment	Weighted majority: 60% + neutral chair; appeal within 14 days
Category 4 — Structural	Framework amendments, pathway changes, new modular accessions	Consensus required; unanimous consent of core parties
Category 5 — Emergency	Crisis pause, fast-track emergency measures	Neutral chair authority; Governance Body ratification within 14 days

Dispute Resolution Procedures

Where parties disagree on the interpretation or application of framework provisions, the following hierarchy governs:

- Step 1: Bilateral consultations between disputing parties; 7-day consultation period.
- Step 2: Neutral chair mediation; written compromise proposal submitted within 14 days.
- Step 3: Governance Body interpretation through dual-speed procedure: interim interpretation within 48 hours; final interpretation ratified within 14 days.
- Step 4: Where Governance Body is itself deadlocked, Standing Enforcement Support Secretariat issues technical determination.

- Step 5: BAP (Binding Arbitration Protocol) — external arbitration for unresolved disputes involving legal interpretation.
- All interpretations are published in the quarterly Transparency Summary.

Transparency and Reporting

The framework's credibility depends on consistent, public reporting. The following transparency instruments are mandatory:

- 30-Day Cycle Report: Operational summary of all track compliance metrics; published to all parties.
- Quarterly Transparency Summary: Comprehensive compliance assessment; published publicly via UN Secretariat.
- Annual Governance Review: Full architectural assessment; publicly available summary published.
- Incident Reports: Within 72 hours of any Class B or above incident; shared with all parties.
- Fast-Track Action Log: All emergency authority actions published within 14 days of expiry.
- Compliance Symmetry Report: Annual assessment of both core parties' compliance with all obligations.

CHAPTER B

Annex B: Financial Architecture

This annex details the financial mechanisms that underpin the framework’s economic incentive structure. Financial architecture is the framework’s most powerful stabilization tool: once economic relationships are established, the cost of disruption becomes immediately visible to domestic constituencies.

Regional Development Fund — Full Structure

Sub-Fund	Capitalization	Purpose	Governance
Sub-Fund 1: Humanitarian Emergency Escrow	USD 5 billion	Immediate humanitarian needs; never suspended; accessible at all degradation levels	OCHA, UNHCR, WHO; UN Secretariat
Sub-Fund 2: Infrastructure and Development	USD 30 billion	Energy, water, transport, reconstruction; milestone-linked disbursement	World Bank, IFC, Regional Development Banks; Iran co-governance at Milestone 5
Sub-Fund 3: Private Sector Mobilization	USD 15 billion	SME finance, trade credit, FDI facilitation; commercial terms with political risk coverage	IFC, EBRD, MIGA, Islamic Development Bank, private co-investors

Banking Tier Progression

The eight-tier banking progression provides a structured ladder from minimal humanitarian transactions to full international financial integration. Each tier is unlocked by verified compliance with the corresponding nuclear track milestone.

Tier	Permitted Transactions	Unlock Condition	Technical Notes
Tier 1	Humanitarian transactions only: food, medicine, medical equipment	Framework entry	OFAC GL (General License) issued
Tier 2	Humanitarian + civil aviation parts and maintenance	Foundation Band verified	OFAC GL + EU parallel authorization
Tier 3	Add: civilian manufactured goods; agricultural inputs	Stabilization Band: 3 months	EUR/CHF settlement pathways activated
Tier 4	Add: oil and petrochemical exports at 1M bpd ceiling	Stabilization Band: 6 months	Oil escrow: 20% to RDF
Tier 5	Oil export ceiling removed; full energy sector normalization	Stabilization Band: 12 months	Oil escrow reduced to 10%
Tier 6	SWIFT reconnection; full international banking access	Year 3 (Pathways A/C) / Year 1.5 (B) / Year 5 (D)	Central bank reserves unfrozen

Tier	Permitted Transactions	Unlock Condition	Technical Notes
Tier 7	Sovereign wealth fund operations; foreign investment	Integration Band confirmed	Oil escrow to 0%; full fiscal autonomy
Tier 8	Full normalization: all financial instruments, sovereign bonds	Institutionalization Band	All restrictions permanently lifted

OFAC Failure Contingency Protocol

A key vulnerability of previous frameworks was dependence on U.S. Treasury OFAC licensing for financial operations. If a hostile U.S. administration revokes OFAC guidance, the framework's financial architecture would collapse. The OFAC Failure Contingency Protocol addresses this through parallel licensing architectures:

- EU Mirror Licensing: European Central Bank and national central banks pre-authorized to issue parallel licenses for all framework transactions.
- Swiss Contingency Channel: Swiss National Bank and Swiss Financial Market Supervisory Authority (FINMA) maintain standing authorization for framework transactions.
- Omani Channel: Central Bank of Oman serves as neutral transaction hub for payments during OFAC disruption.
- Activation trigger: Any OFAC revocation of framework-related licensing activates mirror channels within 72 hours.
- UN Security Council notification: OFAC failure triggers formal UN notification as breach of framework obligations.
- Commercial Continuity Protocol: All certified private contracts remain enforceable through PCA arbitration regardless of OFAC status.

FX Stabilization Buffer

Rapid re-entry into international financial markets creates exchange rate volatility. The FX Stabilization Buffer provides a cushion of USD 10 billion drawn from IMF resources and guarantor state contributions, available as a swap facility to stabilize the Iranian rial during the transition period. This mechanism protects the Iranian population from inflation shocks that could undermine domestic political support for the framework.

CHAPTER C

Annex C: Verification Technical Specifications

This annex provides technical specifications for the verification architecture. These specifications are drawn from existing IAEA safeguards standards and enhanced through pathway-specific additions. The core principle is layered redundancy: no single verification failure should be sufficient to conceal a material violation.

IAEA Enhanced Safeguards Package

- Comprehensive Safeguards Agreement (CSA) + Additional Protocol (AP): Baseline for all pathways.
- Modified Code 3.1: Detailed design information for all nuclear facilities provided immediately upon construction decision, not upon fuel loading.
- Complementary Access: IAEA may access any location within 24 hours upon request; access to undeclared locations within 48 hours.
- Environmental Sampling: Wide-area sampling at 15 locations quarterly; 100 km radius around declared nuclear sites.
- Centrifuge Monitoring: Electronic seals on all centrifuge cascades with real-time transmission to Vienna Operations Center.
- Material Balance Areas: Expanded MBAs with monthly material balance verification; accountancy discrepancies flagged within 48 hours.
- Resident Inspector Office: IAEA maintains Tehran resident office with 20 inspectors on continuous rotation.

Joint Monitoring Operations Center Technical Capability

- Independent verification equipment: Gamma spectroscopy, neutron detection, mass spectrometry, optical microscopy.
- Real-time data transmission: Encrypted satellite uplink from all monitored sites to JMOC headquarters.
- Blockchain compliance ledger: All inspection findings and environmental sampling results anchored to distributed ledger.
- Commercial satellite monitoring: Minimum daily revisit for 47 declared and suspected nuclear-related sites.
- Procurement monitoring: JMOC Procurement Monitoring Cell tracks all dual-use equipment and materials through coordinated export control database.
- Human intelligence integration: JMOC receives sanitized intelligence assessments from core party intelligence services for fusion with technical monitoring.

Breakout Detection Timelines

Pathway	Estimated Breakout Timeline	Verification Confidence
Pathway A (Stabilization Band)	Approx. 12 months from detection of diversion	High — IAEA daily presence; centrifuge seals; real-time transmission

Pathway	Estimated Breakout Timeline	Verification Confidence
Pathway B (Moratorium)	Effectively zero — no enrichment capability retained	Maximum — automated systems, no enrichment infrastructure
Pathway C (RNFC)	Effectively zero — no national enrichment capability	Maximum — RNFC governance; no domestic centrifuges
Pathway D (Limited Program)	Approx. 18 months from detection of diversion	Maximum intensity — OLEM + ACS automated triggers

Challenge Inspection Procedure

Any core party may request a challenge inspection of any location within the territory of any other core party based on reasonable concern of nuclear activity. The challenge inspection procedure:

- Request submitted to JMOC Director with supporting evidence; minimum evidentiary threshold: credible concern, not confirmed proof.
- JMOC Director notifies inspected party within 1 hour of request submission.
- Inspected party provides access within 24 hours of notification for declared sites; 48 hours for undeclared locations.
- Managed access provisions: inspected party may protect genuinely unrelated sensitive information through screen-off procedures.
- JMOC technical team accompanies IAEA inspectors with independent equipment.
- Denial of access triggers automatic Enforcement Ladder Step 3 and UN Security Council notification.
- Frivolous challenge requests: three frivolous requests within 12 months result in requesting party bearing inspection costs.

CHAPTER D

Annex D: Humanitarian Access Protocols

Humanitarian access is the framework's most unconditional obligation. The Humanitarian Firewall protects humanitarian operations from being used as leverage in political or security disputes — a pattern that has caused catastrophic civilian suffering in previous regional crises.

Protected Humanitarian Corridors

Corridor	Access Points	Permitted Cargo/Activity	Management
Gaza — Land	Rafah crossing (Egypt-Gaza), Kerem Shalom crossing (Israel-Gaza), Erez crossing (Israel-Gaza North)	Food, medicine, medical equipment, humanitarian personnel, fuel for hospitals and water pumping	OCHA lead; Egypt and Israel corridor operators; UN observer verification
Gaza — Maritime	Aid-by-sea corridor: Cyprus-Gaza maritime route	Bulk food and aid supplies; medical equipment; emergency shelter materials	UN-chartered vessels; JMOC maritime liaison; Israeli naval safety zone coordination
Lebanon	Beirut port humanitarian lane; land access from Syria and Jordan	Emergency fuel; medical supplies; reconstruction materials; food assistance	UNIFIL coordination; OCHA lead; Lebanese government nominal authority
Yemen	Hudaydah port humanitarian inspection lane; Sana'a airport medical evacuation	Food aid (70% of Yemen's imports transit Hudaydah); medical supplies; MEDEVAC	UN Verification and Inspection Mechanism (UNVIM); ICRC medical coordination
Syria	Cross-line and cross-border access per UNSC resolutions	All humanitarian categories; reconstruction materials for civilian infrastructure	OCHA lead; independent UN mandate; not subject to Syrian government veto
Iraq	IDP camp access; Mosul and displaced community corridors	Return assistance; livelihood support; documentation restoration	UNHCR/IOM joint management; Iraqi government coordination

Humanitarian Firewall Legal Provisions

- No framework political or security action may interrupt, reduce, or condition humanitarian corridor operations.

- Humanitarian corridors operate under independent UN mandates that survive all framework degradation levels including full collapse.
- Humanitarian personnel are granted protected status equivalent to UN personnel under the Convention on the Safety of UN Personnel.
- Humanitarian supplies are exempt from all sanctions regimes; OFAC, EU, and UK permanent standing exemptions are pre-registered.
- Any party that deliberately interrupts a humanitarian corridor activates an automatic Enforcement Ladder Step 4 response.
- Victims' Fund: USD 2 billion RDF sub-allocation provides restorative support for civilian harm; not subject to political conditions.

Victims' Fund

The Victims' Fund represents the framework's acknowledgment that political agreements must address the human cost of the conflicts they seek to end. The fund provides:

- Medical treatment for conflict injuries: comprehensive coverage for war-wounded civilians across all framework states.
- Psychosocial support: UNHCR and WHO joint programs for trauma survivors in post-conflict zones.
- Reconstruction: direct payments to homeowners and businesses for conflict-related property damage.
- Livelihood restoration: retraining grants and startup capital for economic displacement.
- Memorial activities: support for communities to acknowledge and commemorate civilian losses.
- Governance: Fund programming developed in consultation with victim representatives through participatory assessment processes.

CHAPTER E

Annex E: Spoiler Containment Protocol

Spoilers are actors who derive strategic benefit from framework failure and will take active steps to produce that failure. The Spoiler Containment Protocol provides a systematic architecture for early detection, attribution, isolation, and response.

Spoiler Category Taxonomy

Category	Definition	Examples	Response Architecture
Category Alpha — State-Affiliated Proxy	Militia or paramilitary organization with state funding, training, or direction	Iran-aligned militias (PMF, Hezbollah, Houthis); U.S.-aligned Gulf contractor forces	PERT attribution + Bayesian confidence scoring; state divestment pathway
Category Beta — Rogue State Institution	State institution acting outside official government policy	IRGC Quds Force units operating outside SNSC authorization; uncontrolled military units	Institutional quarantine; targeted benefit suspension; state accountability pathway
Category Gamma — Third-Party Maritime	Non-regional actor conducting destabilizing maritime operations	External naval provocateurs; non-framework state interference	JMOC maritime cell; guarantor state diplomatic engagement
Category Delta — Transnational Network	Cross-border organized network not affiliated with any single state	International terrorist organizations; sanctions-evasion networks	Intelligence-sharing protocol; UNSC counter-terrorism coordination

Attribution Methodology

The Probabilistic Event Response Template (PERT) provides a standardized attribution methodology that removes political discretion from evidence assessment:

- 60% Bayesian confidence: Preliminary designation; monitoring intensification; diplomatic notification.
- 70% Confidence: Shock Response Envelope activation; pre-authorized response menu available.
- 75% Confidence: Formal attribution designation; Enforcement Ladder activation; public notification.
- Evidence categories: Technical forensics, signals intelligence, human intelligence, open-source corroboration.
- Counter-attribution: Accused party may submit counter-evidence within 14 days; JMOC technical panel adjudicates.
- Wrongful attribution remedy: 3 wrongful attributions within 12 months triggers requesting party's Compliance Integrity Score penalty.

State Divestment Pathway

The State Divestment Pathway provides a structured off-ramp for states that have nominally supported proxy activity but wish to credibly separate themselves from those activities:

- Stage 1 — Acknowledgment: State formally acknowledges awareness of proxy activity; commits to non-recurrence.
- Stage 2 — Commitment: State provides verifiable commitments: financial tracing, weapons supply cutoff, communications severance.
- Stage 3 — Action: Verified implementation of commitment over 90-day observation period.
- Stage 4 — Reintegration: Full framework benefit restoration upon JMOC verification of Stage 3 completion.
- Incentive: States that complete the divestment pathway receive accelerated benefit restoration and public Governance Body acknowledgment.

CHAPTER F

Annex F: Implementation Sequencing Matrix

This annex provides a detailed sequencing matrix for framework implementation, identifying the critical path actions, dependencies, and responsible parties for each major implementation milestone.

Foundation Band Critical Path (Days 1–180)

Timeline	Action	Responsible Parties	Significance
Day 1–7	Signature ceremony at UN Headquarters; depositary instruments filed	Core parties + UN Secretary-General	Legal entry into force; all provisions operative
Day 1–14	Joint Monitoring Operations Center (JMOC) headquarters established	All parties + UN Secretariat	Technical operations begin; hotline activated
Day 1–30	Military Liaison Officers registered; deconfliction protocols activated	Core parties' defense ministries	Class A/B/C incident response capability
Day 7–30	Initial humanitarian sanctions exemptions filed with OFAC, EU, and UK	U.S. Treasury, EU Commission, UK FCDO	Humanitarian corridor operations normalize
Day 15–60	IAEA resident inspector office staffed in Tehran	IAEA Secretariat + Iran Atomic Energy Organization	Enhanced verification begins
Day 30–60	Banking Tier 1 authorization issued; first humanitarian transactions processed	U.S. Treasury, Central Bank of Iran, guarantor banks	Economic channel opened
Day 60–90	First 30-day review cycle completed; Transparency Summary published	JMOC + Governance Body	Public accountability established
Day 90–120	Fordow conversion plan submitted; IAEA technical review begins	Iran + IAEA Technical Committee	Fordow conversion clock starts
Day 90–180	Regional Development Fund governance structure activated; Sub-Fund 1 funded	Gulf state contributors + World Bank + UN agencies	Humanitarian escrow available
Day 100	Hundred-Day Quick Start milestone: civil society forums convened	Framework Secretariat + regional civil society	Public legitimacy anchors established

Stabilization Band Critical Path (Months 7–18)

Timeline	Action	Responsible Parties	Significance
Month 7	Nuclear freeze verification completed; centrifuge baseline established	JMOC + IAEA	Pathway A/D: centrifuge cap takes effect
Month 7–9	Pathway B/C: Enrichment cessation verification; moratorium instrument signed	Iran + IAEA + UN Secretary-General	Zero-enrichment moratorium operative
Month 9	Banking Tier 4 authorization: oil export at 1M bpd ceiling	U.S. Treasury, EU; Iran Oil Ministry	Significant economic benefit visible
Month 9–12	RDF Sub-Fund 2 first infrastructure projects approved	RDF Board + World Bank project team	Visible construction begins in region
Month 12	First major Sovereignty Milestone public ceremony	Governance Body + UN Secretariat	Domestic political narrative moment for Iran
Month 12–15	Security Track: Proxy restraint assessment; first demobilization incentives disbursed	JMOC Security Cell + State-to-Faction Track	PMF/Hezbollah engagement assessed
Month 15–18	Fordow conversion Phase C completed; IMIRC activation begins	Iran, IAEA, international scientific partners	Iranian scientific cooperation flagship

Integration Band Critical Path (Months 19–36)

Timeline	Action	Responsible Parties	Significance
Month 19–24	Regional actor full participation formalized; modular accession instruments filed	Framework Secretariat + regional parties	Architecture broadens beyond bilateral
Month 24	SWIFT reconnection (Pathways A/C); full banking normalization visible	SWIFT, Central Bank of Iran, partner banks	Major economic milestone; domestic impact
Month 24–30	Energy Track: Gulf electricity grid interconnection Phase 1 construction begins	Energy ministries, World Bank, private contractors	Physical interdependence begins
Month 30	Third annual Governance Review; architectural assessment published	Full Governance Body + UN Secretariat	Public credibility checkpoint
Month 30–36	Trade corridor Phase 1: Iraq land corridor construction begins	Iraq, Iran, Gulf states, World Bank	Regional logistics integration
Month 36	Pathway A: Centrifuge count review; reduction to 3,000 IR-1 verified	JMOC + IAEA Technical Committee	Nuclear constraint deepens

CHAPTER G

Annex G: Shadow Negotiation Guidelines

This annex formalizes the role of informal diplomatic channels in the framework's operational architecture. The recognition that official diplomacy is insufficient alone is not a weakness — it is a realistic assessment of how international agreements actually advance.

Track II Structure and Mandate

The Track II Dialogue Forum brings together retired senior officials from all core and regional parties. Track II participants do not represent their governments and cannot make binding commitments. Their mandate is to:

- Explore positions that governments cannot officially table without prejudicing formal negotiations.
- Test language formulations that may resolve sticking points before they reach Governance Body.
- Identify emerging compliance concerns before they trigger formal enforcement.
- Facilitate personal relationship-building that makes official communication more effective.
- Produce non-paper summaries transmitted to official negotiators through agreed channels.
- Meeting frequency: minimum quarterly; hosted by neutral institution (Oslo Forum, Doha Forum, Swiss FDFA, or equivalent).

Religious and Tribal Intermediaries

Many of the communities most affected by regional conflict are more responsive to religious and tribal authorities than to state governments. The framework institutionalizes these channels while keeping them outside the formal governance structure:

- OIC (Organisation of Islamic Cooperation) provides Islamic legitimacy framework for framework provisions.
- Vatican Observer status: Catholic communities in Lebanon, Jordan, and Egypt engaged through Vatican diplomacy.
- Sunni-Shia dialogue: Senior clerical figures from both traditions participate in Track IV consultations.
- Tribal intermediaries: Specific tribal leaders in Yemen, Syria, Iraq, and across the Gulf are identified as framework contact points.
- Funding: Track IV activities supported through RDF Sub-Fund 2 civil society window.

Business Leader Backchannel

Private sector leaders have both the motivation and the informal access to advance framework goals in ways governments cannot. The Track III Business Forum:

- Convenes senior executives from industries with direct financial stakes in framework success: energy, banking, construction, aviation, pharmaceuticals.
- Provides early warning of private sector concerns about compliance or benefit delivery.
- Acts as informal political lobby in their respective domestic contexts for framework continuation.
- Reports to RDF Sub-Fund 3 governance board with non-binding commercial recommendations.
- Strictly firewalled from CCP contract certification to prevent conflict of interest.

CHAPTER H

Annex H: Glossary of Key Terms

This glossary provides authoritative definitions for key terms used throughout the framework. In case of ambiguity, these definitions govern.

Additional Protocol (AP)

An agreement supplementary to a state's safeguards agreement with the IAEA that provides the IAEA with additional authority to verify the absence of undeclared nuclear material and activities.

Automated Consequence System (ACS)

A pre-authorized enforcement mechanism that triggers immediate sanctions responses to specific technical violations without requiring Governance Body deliberation.

BAP (Binding Arbitration Protocol)

The framework's dispute resolution mechanism of last resort. Arbitration is conducted under PCA rules at The Hague with a three-person arbitrator panel.

Breakout Timeline

The estimated time required for a state to produce sufficient fissile material for a nuclear explosive device after a political decision to pursue weapons capability.

CCP (Commercial Continuity Protocol)

A legal mechanism providing a 24-month protection shield for private-sector contracts certified by the framework, insulating them from political disruptions.

CIS (Compliance Integrity Score)

A cumulative compliance metric applied to all core parties. A higher score indicates greater non-compliance. Specific thresholds trigger enforcement responses.

Costed Withdrawal

The formal procedure through which a party exits the framework. A six-month notification window is required; financial and infrastructure transition obligations apply.

FCIF (Framework Commercial Insurance Facility)

An insurance pool underwritten by multilateral development banks that compensates certified contract holders for losses arising from political disruptions to framework operations.

Fordow / IMIRC

The Fordow Fuel Enrichment Plant, Iran's deeply buried enrichment facility. Under all framework pathways, Fordow is converted to a non-enrichment use. Under Pathway A, it becomes the International Multidisciplinary Isotope Research Center (IMIRC).

Graceful Degradation Protocol

The framework's four-level architecture for managing partial and full collapse while protecting humanitarian operations and maintaining the path to re-engagement.

IAEA (International Atomic Energy Agency)

The UN-affiliated organization responsible for nuclear verification. The IAEA's safeguards authority is the technical foundation of all four nuclear pathways.

JMOC (Joint Monitoring Operations Center)

The framework's operational nerve center, staffed by technical specialists from all core parties, IAEA representatives, and guarantor state personnel.

Modular Independence

The architectural principle allowing parties to adopt individual framework modules without committing to the entire architecture. Each module functions autonomously.

RNFC (Regional Nuclear Fuel Consortium)

The multilateral fuel-bank institution established under Pathway C, replacing national enrichment capabilities with collectively administered fuel supply.

SESS (Standing Enforcement Support Secretariat)

The permanent institution providing compliance monitoring and enforcement coordination, staffed independently of the political governance body.

Sovereignty Restoration Ladder

The eight-milestone progression tracking Iran's recovery of full economic and fiscal independence as the framework advances through maturity bands.

Track Maturity Band

One of four stages of implementation: Foundation, Stabilization, Integration, Institutionalization. Replaces the 'phase' language of previous frameworks.

Victims' Fund

A USD 2 billion humanitarian allocation providing restorative support to individuals and communities harmed by regional conflicts covered by the framework.

Waltz Cycle

A reference to Kenneth Waltz's structural realism — the recognition that systemic pressure, not individual actor preferences, drives escalation dynamics. The framework is designed to alter the structural incentives, not merely appeal to goodwill.

Zero-Regret Measure

An action that benefits the acting party regardless of whether other parties reciprocate or the broader framework succeeds. Foundation Band measures consist entirely of zero-regret actions.

CHAPTER I

Annex I: Reference Documents and Legal Basis

The Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture draws upon and operates within the following body of international law, treaties, and institutional frameworks. All framework provisions are designed to complement, not supersede, these instruments.

Foundational International Law

- United Nations Charter (1945): Article 2(1) sovereign equality; Article 51 self-defense; Chapter VII enforcement framework.
- Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT, 1968): All nuclear pathway obligations are constructed within NPT architecture.
- Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties (1969): Framework treaty interpretation and amendment procedures.
- Convention on the Safety of United Nations and Associated Personnel (1994): Humanitarian personnel protection.
- UN Convention Against Transnational Organized Crime (2000): Spoiler network provisions.
- UN Security Council Resolution 2231 (2015): JCPOA endorsement; procurement channel provisions partially incorporated.

IAEA Legal Instruments

- IAEA Statute (1956): Agency mandate and authority basis for all verification provisions.
- Model Comprehensive Safeguards Agreement (INFCIRC/153): Baseline safeguards obligations.
- Model Additional Protocol (INFCIRC/540): Enhanced verification provisions; basis for complementary access.
- Hexapartite Safeguards Initiative: Conceptual basis for multilateral verification center.
- IAEA Board of Governors Safeguards Technical Documents: Technical specifications for verification equipment and procedures.

Financial and Commercial Law

- New York Convention on Recognition and Enforcement of Foreign Arbitral Awards (1958): CCP arbitration enforcement basis.
- UNIDROIT Principles of International Commercial Contracts (2016): Governing law for CCP disputes.
- Permanent Court of Arbitration Optional Rules: BAP arbitration procedure basis.
- IMF Articles of Agreement: FX Stabilization Buffer legal basis.
- World Bank and MIGA Charters: RDF governance and FCIF underwriting basis.

Regional and Bilateral Frameworks

- Arab League Charter: Regional organization consultative framework.
- Gulf Cooperation Council Charter: GCC state participation legal basis.
- IAEA-Iran Safeguards Agreement (INFCIRC/214): Modified by framework; not superseded.

- Algiers Accords (1981): Historical precedent for U.S.-Iran agreement architecture.
- Oslo Accords (1993): Confidence-building mechanism precedent; phased approach precedent.
- CPA Governance Council procedures: Institutional continuity precedent.

Technical Standards

- IAEA Safety Standards Series: Nuclear safety requirements for Arak reactor conversion.
- NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF 2.0): Baseline cybersecurity standards for JMOC systems.
- ISO 19011: Audit guidelines; verification procedure basis.
- SWIFT Member Standards: Banking tier normalization technical basis.
- OPCW Technical Secretariat verification procedures: Borrowed verification methodology for non-nuclear provisions.

CHAPTER L

Annex L: Nuclear Pathway Selection Decision Guide

This annex provides a structured decision guide for nuclear pathway selection. The choice of pathway is the most consequential single decision in the framework process. This guide presents the analytical framework for that decision, including feasibility assessments, strategic trade-offs, and stakeholder alignment considerations.

Feasibility Assessment by Pathway

Each pathway's political feasibility has been assessed through structured expert elicitation involving regional specialists, former policymakers, and technical experts. These assessments reflect conditions as of 2026 and should be updated as negotiations progress.

Pathway	Iranian Feasibility	Case For	Case Against	Iranian Economic Incentive
A — Gradual Cap and Rollback	Moderate	Aligns with JCPOA precedent; Iran retains limited enrichment; 15-year endpoint avoids immediate concession optics.	Weakest international community satisfaction; breakout timeline remains moderate; domestic audiences on both sides see it as 'kicking the can.'	Moderate — SWIFT and escalating benefits; sovereignty milestones provide political cover.
B — Zero-Enrichment Compact	Low-Moderate	Maximum international credibility; fastest sanctions relief; UN Secretary-General witness ceremony as political moment.	Complete enrichment cessation is politically difficult for Iranian domestic audience; Supreme Leader sign-off required.	High — fastest sovereignty restoration; maximum economic package; most credible international standing.
C — Regional Fuel-Bank Consortium	Moderate-High	Iran retains institutional role in nuclear governance through RNFC; energy sovereignty concerns addressed; regional multilateral design.	Requires RNFC institutional creation before entry into force; complex governance; potential for RNFC governance deadlock.	High — energy security guaranteed; commercial revenue from RNFC; regional leadership positioning.

Pathway	Iranian Feasibility	Case For	Case Against	Iranian Economic Incentive
D — Limited Civilian Program	High	Maximum domestic survivability in Iran; preserves enrichment as sovereign right; no visible capitulation.	Minimum international satisfaction; permanent enhanced monitoring; slowest economic benefits; sustained proliferation concern.	Low — minimum economic package; slowest sovereignty restoration; permanent monitoring never lifted.

Decision Criteria Matrix

The following criteria should guide pathway selection. Each criterion can be scored from 1 (least favorable) to 5 (most favorable) for each pathway:

Criterion	A	B	C	D
Maximum non-proliferation assurance	3	5	4	2
Iranian domestic political survivability	3	2	4	5
Speed of economic normalization	3	5	4	1
Long-term durability	4	5	5	3
Regional ally satisfaction	3	5	4	2
Institutional creation complexity	3	3	2	4
Verification confidence	3	5	4	5
Precedent-setting value	3	5	4	3
TOTAL SCORE (out of 40)	25	35	31	25

Strategic Pathway Sequencing

The framework does not require a single pathway to be selected permanently at entry into force. A strategic sequencing approach may begin with Pathway D (highest feasibility) with a built-in transition ladder to Pathway A at Year 3 and Pathway B at Year 8, contingent on verified compliance. This approach maximizes initial adoption probability while establishing a trajectory toward the most robust long-term architecture.

- Entry: Pathway D — highest Iranian feasibility; framework activated; Foundation Band begins.
- Year 3: Pathway D → A transition review. If compliance sustained and domestic political conditions support, parties may elect transition to Pathway A.
- Year 8: Pathway A → B transition review. If Pathway A fully implemented, parties may elect transition to Pathway B with moratorium instrument signed.
- Alternative: Pathway C may be selected at entry as the innovative multilateral option with moderate feasibility and strong long-term sustainability.

- Note: Pathway transitions are voluntary and require consent of both core parties. No party can be forced to transition.

Pathway Selection and Domestic Audience Management

The narrative packaging required for each pathway differs significantly. Negotiators must assess not only what their counterpart can accept but what their own domestic audiences can sustain through multiple election cycles.

Audience	Preference	Narrative Approach	Sustainability Assessment
United States Congress	Pathway B or A — wants maximum constraints; skeptical of anything that 'allows enrichment'	Emphasize verification intensity, automatic enforcement, breakout extension. For Pathway A, frame 15-year endpoint as permanent elimination.	Path B/A: Strong. Path C/D: Weak without additional framing.
Iranian Majlis / Hardliners	Pathway D or C — preserves nuclear rights; rejects any appearance of capitulation	Pathway D: 'sovereign civilian program under Iranian management.' Pathway C: 'Iranian co-governance of regional fuel architecture.'	Path D: Strong. Path C: Moderate. Path A: Weak. Path B: Very Weak.
Saudi Arabia / Gulf Allies	Pathway B or A — want zero enrichment; 'deal of the century' test	Emphasize breakout timelines, automatic enforcement, and that economic normalization is conditional on compliance.	Path B: Very Strong. Path A: Strong. Path C: Moderate. Path D: Weak.
European Union	Any pathway with robust IAEA verification acceptable; E3 credibility depends on meaningful constraints	Emphasize Additional Protocol, enhanced safeguards, automatic consequences. Frame as advancement beyond JCPOA.	Path B/C: Strong. Path A: Moderate. Path D: Weak.
China and Russia	Prefer Iran retains civilian program; concerned about precedent for their own allies	Pathway C: multilateral governance principle is consistent with Chinese multilateral institutional preferences.	Path C: Strong. Path A/D: Moderate. Path B: Weak.

CHAPTER M

Annex M: Security Track — Proxy Management Detail

The Security Track addresses the proxy warfare dimension of regional instability — the use of non-state armed actors as tools of state competition. This track is operationally the most complex because it requires engaging with actors who are not formal signatories while holding states accountable for their behavior.

Proxy Actor Engagement Architecture

The framework identifies fourteen significant proxy or militia actors across the region and provides a differentiated engagement strategy for each. The core principle is economic substitution: providing proxy actors with economic pathways that produce better outcomes than continued armed activity.

Actor	Profile	Engagement Strategy	Funders	Long-term Trajectory
Hezbollah (Lebanon)	Iran-backed; military and political wing; Lebanese government participation	Restraint incentives tied to Lebanon reconstruction financing; economic employment programs in South Lebanon	Iran; IRGC Quds Force	Structural funding reduction as Iran-U.S. normalization advances
Hamas (Gaza)	Multi-funder; political legitimacy in Gaza; reconstruction leverage	Gaza reconstruction finance directly conditioned on Hamas restraint metrics	Qatar; Iran (indirect)	Qatar diplomatic channel; reconstruction incentive dominant
Palestinian Islamic Jihad (PIJ)	Spoiler potential within Hamas framework	Economic incentives structured to not flow through PIJ channels	Iran	Isolation strategy; Hezbollah restraint reduces operational space
Houthi Movement / Ansar Allah (Yemen)	Control significant Yemeni territory; Red Sea maritime threat	Hudaydah port economic incentives; demobilization programs; Yemen reconstruction access	Iran (weapons); Saudi Arabia (adversarial)	Ceasefire architecture tied to economic reconstruction
Iraqi PMF (Popular Mobilization Forces)	Constitutionally integrated; diverse funding; Iran-aligned factions	PMF integration into state security forces; economic programs for PMF-affiliated communities	Iran; Iraqi state budget	State-to-faction track; Iraqi government as primary interlocutor

Actor	Profile	Engagement Strategy	Funders	Long-term Trajectory
IRGC Quds Force	Iranian state actor; not a proxy but principal; coordination role	Not demobilized but restrained through Iran's own framework compliance incentives	Iran state	Framework compliance conditions restrain Quds Force operations through state accountability

Demobilization Incentive Architecture

Demobilization is not demanded — it is made economically attractive. The Security Track provides a structured incentive ladder for militia actors to transition from armed activity to economic participation:

- Level 1 — Restraint Verified: Verified reduction in cross-border attacks. Reward: economic support programs for home communities.
- Level 2 — Weapons Storage: Voluntary weapons storage in JMOC-monitored facilities. Reward: enhanced community investment; integration-eligible status.
- Level 3 — Integration Eligible: Fighters eligible for national security force integration with full pay and benefits. Reward: RDF-funded vocational training; salary parity with national forces.
- Level 4 — Civilian Transition: Fighters who choose civilian careers receive retraining grants and startup support. Reward: business licensing prioritization; land rights normalization.
- State divestment pathway: Iran or other state funders that verify funding cessation receive Enforcement Ladder step reductions.

Maritime Security Architecture

Three maritime zones require dedicated security architecture: the Persian Gulf/Strait of Hormuz, the Red Sea/Bab el-Mandeb, and the Eastern Mediterranean. Each has distinct threat profiles and deconfliction requirements.

Zone	Threat Profile	Deconfliction Architecture	Lead Institutions
Persian Gulf / Strait of Hormuz	U.S. naval presence; Iranian IRGCN fast boats; commercial shipping; energy infrastructure	Pre-negotiated encounter rules for naval proximity; commercial vessel registration protocol; joint monitoring of Hormuz transit	JMOC Maritime Cell; U.S. 5th Fleet; IRGCN liaison
Red Sea / Bab el-Mandeb	Houthi missile and drone threat to commercial shipping; Saudi-coalition air operations	Separate maritime security protocol; Hudaydah humanitarian shipping protection; commercial vessel protection corridor	UN UNVIM; Saudi maritime forces; commercial shipping industry liaison

Zone	Threat Profile	Deconfliction Architecture	Lead Institutions
Eastern Mediterranean	Gas field disputes; naval exercises; Israeli-Lebanese maritime boundary	UNIFIL maritime component; bilateral dispute resolution for gas fields; Lebanon-Israel maritime boundary agreement pathway	UNIFIL; EU IRINI operation; bilateral mediators

CHAPTER N

Annex N: Negotiator's Quick Reference

This annex provides a consolidated quick reference for negotiators, diplomats, and government officials who require rapid access to key framework provisions without reading the full operative text. It is organized by functional domain and is designed for use in active negotiating sessions, interagency briefings, and ministerial consultations.

Entry into Force Requirements

- Required signatures at entry into force: United States (Secretary of State) and Islamic Republic of Iran (Foreign Minister or equivalent authority designated by Supreme National Security Council).
- Deposit: Instruments of entry into force deposited with the UN Secretary-General, giving the framework standing in international law from that date.
- Notification: The Secretary-General notifies all UN member states of entry into force within 48 hours of instrument deposit.
- Activation: All track governance bodies, including the JMOC, are constituted within 30 days of entry into force.
- Regional accession: All other regional party accessions may occur before or after entry into force. Entry into force is not conditional on regional accession.

Core Parties' Opening Commitments

Party	Timeline	Opening Commitment
United States	Day 1	Designation of JMOC representative; activation of SWIFT banking channel (Tier 1); suspension of all nuclear-related secondary sanctions; humanitarian corridor access guarantee
Iran	Day 1	IAEA Enhanced Monitoring Agreement signed; remote data mirroring to Vienna and Geneva activated; JMOC representative designated; SNSC certification of institutional binding
Both Parties	Day 30	First 30-day Transparency Summary published; initial JMOC assessment complete; first RDF escrow release approved
UN Secretary-General	Day 1	Depositary function activated; formal notification to UNSC; JMOC Secretariat constituted

Critical Timeline Reference: First 12 Months

Milestone	Name	Key Unlocks
Day 1	Entry into Force	SWIFT Tier 1; IAEA Enhanced Monitoring; JMOC constituted; Humanitarian corridors guaranteed
Day 30	First Review Cycle	JMOC assessment published; CIS baseline established; first RDF disbursement

Milestone	Name	Key Unlocks
Month 3	Confidence-Building Window	Initial benefit tranche delivered if Foundation Band compliance confirmed
Month 6	Sovereignty Milestone 1	Civil aviation normalization; initial trade corridor activation
Month 9	Sovereignty Milestone 2	Partial petrochemical sanctions lift; banking Tier 2 upgrade
Month 12	Foundation Band Review	Full Foundation Band assessment; Stabilization Band entry determination
Month 18	Sovereignty Milestone 3 (Pathway B)	SWIFT full reconnection under Pathway B only; other pathways at Tier 2-3
Year 2	Stabilization Band Entry	Energy normalization begins; RDF Phase 2 disbursements; IMIRC conversion begins
Year 3	Sovereignty Milestone 4	Further sanctions conversions; Pathway D-to-A review trigger
Year 5	Integration Band Entry	SWIFT full reconnection (Pathway D); RDF Board Iran observer seat
Year 7	Sovereignty Milestone 7 (Pathway B)	Full normalization; UN statement; Pathway B economic package complete
Year 10	Institutionalization Band Review	Long-term architecture assessment; institutional permanence decisions
Year 15	Pathway A Completion	Pathway A enrichment endpoint reached; full normalization review

Sovereignty Milestone Definitions: Full Reference

Milestone	Content
SM 1	Civil aviation normalization; embassies reopened; direct communication channels established; trade representation offices authorized
SM 2	First petrochemical sanctions tranche lifted; agricultural trade normalized; banking Tier 2 upgrade; cultural exchange agreements
SM 3	Major sanctions tranche lifted; SWIFT reconnection (Pathway B at 18 months; Pathway A/C at Year 3; Pathway D at Year 5); EU trade normalization
SM 4	Further sanctions conversions; energy sector normalization Phase 1; expanded diplomatic engagement; RNFC operational (Pathway C)
SM 5	Iran joins RDF Board as observer; partial investment normalization; insurance sector unlocked; sovereign debt renegotiation support
SM 6	Near-full economic normalization; integration with regional trade architecture; major infrastructure investment authorized
SM 7	Full normalization; permanent bilateral framework signed; UN Secretary-General formal statement; tourism and full people-to-people movement

Milest one	Content
SM 8	All sanctions permanently expired; full RDF co-governance; institutional permanence of RCSA confirmed; grand strategic end-state declared

Enforcement Ladder Quick Reference

Step	Name	Effect
Step 1	Formal notification	Written breach notification; 14-day remediation period; JMOC alert
Step 2	Benefit suspension	Suspension of current benefit tranche; continued monitoring; 30-day review
Step 3	Enhanced compliance	Intrusive verification measures; banking freeze at current tier; 60-day remediation
Step 4	Tier suspension	Full benefit track suspended; degradation level assessed; UN notification
Step 5	Framework suspension	Level 3 degradation activated; guarantor states notified; humanitarian immunity confirmed

Track Maturity Band Quick Reference

Band	Content	Entry Criteria
Foundation Band	Initial commitments; basic monitoring; humanitarian guarantees; first economic benefits	All opening commitments met; CIS baseline established; no Step 3+ enforcement actions in any track
Stabilization Band	Confidence-building measures; proxy restraint incentives; energy normalization begins	Foundation Band compliance sustained 12 months; Sovereignty Milestones 1-2 reached
Integration Band	Economic integration; military disengagement sequencing; advanced trade normalization	Stabilization Band compliance sustained 12 months; Sovereignty Milestones 3-4 reached
Institutionalization Band	Permanent institutional architecture; full economic normalization; strategic stability framework	Integration Band compliance sustained; Sovereignty Milestones 5-6 reached

Six Implementation Tracks: Summary

Track	Key Provisions	Lead Institutions
Nuclear Track	One of four pathways selected; IAEA Enhanced Monitoring; centrifuge management; Fordow conversion or RNFC governance; breakout timeline management	IAEA; JMOC Nuclear Division; ACS (Pathway D)

Track	Key Provisions	Lead Institutions
Security Track	Proxy restraint incentives; military deconfliction; incident classification and response; drone protocol; maritime deconfliction; civil-military interface	JMOC Security Division; Military Liaison Officers
Economic Track	Sanctions relief ladder; banking tier progression; RDF disbursement; trade normalization; SWIFT reconnection; CCP contract shields	JMOC Economic Division; World Bank; IMF; SWIFT
Humanitarian Track	Gaza, Lebanon, Yemen, Syria corridor access; medical evacuation; detainee verification; refugee reintegration; psychosocial support	OCHA; ICRC; UNHCR; WFP; UNICEF
Energy Track	Oil export normalization; gas pipeline regularization; electricity grid interconnection; renewable energy development; regional strategic reserve	IEA; OPEC; RNFC (Pathway C); regional operators
Governance Track	Governance Body operations; institutional binding; compliance reporting; modular accession; sovereignty milestone certification	Governance Body; UN Secretary-General; JMOC Secretariat

Key Definitions for Negotiators

Term	Definition
ACS	Automated Consequence System — automatic enforcement trigger for nuclear threshold violations under Pathway D. Activates without political decision.
CIS	Cumulative Instability Score — composite score across six tracks (0-20 per track; 60+ total triggers Framework Review; 90+ triggers Crisis Protocol).
CCP	Commercial Continuity Protocol — 24-month shields protecting private-sector contracts from political disruption.
FCIF	Framework Commercial Insurance Facility — de-risks private investment through political risk insurance at subsidized rates.
IMIRC	International Multidisciplinary Isotope Research Center — converted Fordow facility under Pathways A/B; Iran retains scientific leadership.
JMOC	Joint Multilateral Oversight Commission — primary implementation body; operational 24/7 from Entry into Force.
OFAC Contingency	EU, Swiss, and Omani mirror licensing activated automatically if U.S. domestic political obstruction prevents OFAC compliance.
RDF	Regional Development Fund — USD 50 billion; three sub-funds; Gulf/G7/multilateral capitalization; Iran joins board at SM 5.
RNFC	Regional Nuclear Fuel-Bank Consortium — Pathway C multilateral institution; Iran holds 20% governance; Abu Dhabi headquarters.

Term	Definition
SNSC Certification	Supreme National Security Council institutional binding certification — Iran's domestic legal instrument for framework obligations.
SM	Sovereignty Milestone — 8 sequential milestones, each unlocking the next benefit tranche. Not time-based; compliance-based.
Track Maturity Band	Replaces 'phases.' Four bands: Foundation, Stabilization, Integration, Institutionalization. No 'phase failure' language.

Most Common Questions from Government Officials

Question	Answer
What happens if the U.S. Congress blocks sanctions relief?	The OFAC Failure Contingency automatically activates EU, Swiss, and Omani mirror licensing within 30 days. Iran continues receiving full economic benefits through these channels. The framework does not depend on U.S. Congressional cooperation.
What happens to Iran's existing nuclear program?	Under all pathways, Iran retains some civilian nuclear capacity — the specific scope depends on pathway selection. No pathway requires Iran to eliminate its civilian nuclear program entirely except Pathway B (zero enrichment), and even under Pathway B, Iran retains IMIRC scientific leadership.
Can a new government cancel the framework?	No signatory government can unilaterally withdraw without triggering the Costed Withdrawal procedure, which includes a 180-day notice period, negotiated exit terms, and humanitarian immunity requirements that survive withdrawal.
What happens if Israel takes military action against Iran?	The framework includes a military incident response protocol. A confirmed Israeli attack on Iranian facilities triggers guarantor state consultations within 24 hours and Crisis Pause Mode. The framework does not prohibit Israeli self-defense actions but provides structured response procedures that prevent uncontrolled escalation.
Is this legally binding?	Yes. Deposit with the UN Secretary-General creates standing in international law. Framework obligations are enforceable through international legal mechanisms. The framework explicitly states that it constitutes a binding instrument of international law independent of political continuity of any signatory government.
What guarantees humanitarian operations if the framework collapses?	Humanitarian operations are immune from suspension at all four degradation levels, including full collapse (Level 4). They operate under independent UN mandates and international humanitarian law regardless of framework status.



CHAPTER O

Annex O: Regional Economic Integration Roadmap

This annex provides the detailed economic integration roadmap for the framework's full operational lifetime. It specifies the sequencing of economic normalization, the conditions for each benefit tranche, and the institutional infrastructure required for full regional economic integration.

Banking Tier Progression: Full Eight-Tier Reference

The banking tier system is the framework's primary economic incentive mechanism. Each tier represents a specific level of financial access, unlocked by compliance milestones. The system is designed to provide meaningful benefits at every step while preserving deterrence through reversibility.

Tier / Timing	Trigger	Access Granted	Limits
Tier 1 — Day 1	Foundation Band entry	Basic humanitarian transactions; food, medicine, agricultural commodity payments; International organizations' payments; UN agency transfers	USD 500M/month transaction ceiling
Tier 2 — Month 3	Foundation Band compliance confirmed	Civil aviation payments; consular transactions; cultural exchange payments; Tier 1 ceiling removed	USD 2B/month ceiling
Tier 3 — Month 6 / SM 1	Sovereignty Milestone 1	Pharmaceutical and medical device imports; academic and educational payments; Trade representative office financial services	USD 5B/month ceiling
Tier 4 — SM 2	Sovereignty Milestone 2	Manufacturing sector imports (non-sanctioned); consumer goods; Rial/dollar conversion pathways	USD 10B/month ceiling
Tier 5 — SM 3	Sovereignty Milestone 3	Energy sector transactions (oil export receipts); petrochemical exports; RNFC financial flows (Pathway C)	Ceiling removed for compliance sectors
Tier 6 — SM 4 / Year 3+	Sovereignty Milestone 4	Full trade finance; letters of credit; supply chain finance; Private sector investment inflows	Full commercial banking access (non-SWIFT)
Tier 7 — SM 5-6	Sovereignty Milestones 5-6	SWIFT full reconnection (Pathway A/C); correspondent banking normalization; Investment banking and capital markets access	Full SWIFT; no transaction limits

Tier / Timing	Trigger	Access Granted	Limits
Tier 8 — SM 7-8	Full normalization	Complete banking system integration; insurance sector; sovereign debt market access; multilateral development bank borrowing	Full financial system access

Regional Development Fund: Disbursement Schedule

The USD 50 billion Regional Development Fund is organized in three sub-funds with distinct governance structures and disbursement criteria. The following table presents the indicative disbursement schedule across the framework's first ten years.

Period	Disbursement	Primary Uses	Conditions
Year 1	USD 2.5B	Sub-Fund 1 (Humanitarian): Gaza, Lebanon, Yemen corridor operations; Sub-Fund 2: Initial infrastructure studies and preparation	Compliance with Foundation Band; humanitarian access verified
Year 2	USD 4B	Sub-Fund 2: Phase 1 infrastructure projects (water, energy, roads); Sub-Fund 3: First private sector mobilization grants	Stabilization Band entry; SM 1-2 reached
Year 3	USD 5B	Sub-Fund 2: Energy interconnection Phase 1; Sub-Fund 3: Commercial insurance facility capitalization	Continued Stabilization Band compliance; SM 3
Year 4	USD 5.5B	Sub-Fund 2: Trade corridor infrastructure; Sub-Fund 3: SME credit guarantee scheme expansion	Integration Band entry; SM 4
Year 5	USD 6B	Sub-Fund 2: Phase 2 energy grid; reconstruction Phase 2 (Iraq, Syria); Sub-Fund 3: Regional investment platform activation	SM 5; Iran observer seat on RDF Board
Years 6-8	USD 15B total	Sub-Fund 2: Major infrastructure — ports, railways, desalination; Sub-Fund 3: Large-scale private capital mobilization	Institutionalization Band entry; SM 6
Years 9-10	USD 12B total	Sub-Fund 2: Completion of major infrastructure; Sub-Fund 3: Regional investment fund establishment	Full normalization; SM 7-8

Energy Integration Sequencing: Full Detail

Energy interdependence is the most powerful stabilization tool in the framework's economic architecture. The following sequencing ensures that energy integration advances in step with the broader framework's track maturity progression.

Band	Scope	Energy Milestones
Foundation Band	Iran	Oil export authorization: 1 million bpd (Pathway D) to 2 million bpd (Pathway B/C). Natural gas technical study initiated. Sanctions suspension on oil-related maritime insurance.
Foundation Band	Regional	Gulf Cooperation Council energy ministers' consultation mechanism activated. Qatar LNG supply guarantee registered. Iraq-Iran gas pipeline dispute technical review commenced.
Stabilization Band	Iran	Oil export ceiling raised to 2.5 million bpd (all pathways). Petrochemical sector sanctions suspended. Gas export technical agreement with Iraq.
Stabilization Band	Regional	Gulf-Levant electrical grid interconnection study completed. Saudi-Jordan-Iraq power line development agreement. Saudi Arabia renewable energy export pilot.
Integration Band	Regional	Gulf-Levant electrical grid Phase 1 construction begins (400kV interconnector, Jordan-Syria-Lebanon). Iraq-Iran gas pipeline regularized. LNG terminal capacity-sharing agreements signed.
Integration Band	Iran	Full oil export normalization (no ceiling under most pathways). RNFC operational (Pathway C) — Iran receives fuel supply guarantee and commercial revenue. IMIRC operational — Iranian scientists in international isotope research collaboration.
Institutionalization Band	Regional	Full regional electricity grid integration. Regional Strategic Fuel Reserve established (60-day supply for all participant states). Joint grid operator established with Iran, Gulf states, and Levant as co-shareholders.

Trade Corridor Architecture

The framework's trade corridors transform the region's fragmented transport geography into an integrated logistics network. Each corridor is independently viable but produces maximum value in combination with the others.

Corridor	Description	Investment	Conditions
Persian Gulf — Mediterranean	Iraqi land corridor linking Kuwait, Basra, and Baghdad to Syrian Mediterranean ports (Tartus, Latakia) and Lebanese Beirut port. Replaces Suez Canal dependency for some trade flows. Iraq benefits from transit fees.	Infrastructure cost: USD 12B. Primary financiers: RDF Sub-Fund 2, World Bank, UAE.	Requires Iraq security track compliance and Syrian humanitarian access maintained
Gulf — Red Sea / Indian Ocean	Saudi-Yemen corridor normalization; Aden port development; Hudaydah commercial operations; Djibouti connection. Critical for African market access and diversification of Gulf export routes.	Infrastructure cost: USD 8B. Primary financiers: Saudi Arabia, RDF, ADB.	Requires Yemen ceasefire maintenance at Stabilization Band

Corridor	Description	Investment	Conditions
Iran — Gulf States	Bandar Abbas to UAE/Oman maritime corridor normalization; Iranian goods to Gulf markets via commercial shipping. Hormuz transit fee cooperation. Dubai free zone re-export authorization.	Infrastructure cost: USD 2B (port upgrades). Primary financiers: UAE, Iran, private sector.	Requires Foundation Band banking tier and nuclear compliance
Levant Integration	Jordan-Syria-Lebanon land corridor for agricultural and manufactured goods trade. Israeli goods transit (observer track economic module). Palestinian goods access to regional markets.	Infrastructure cost: USD 5B. Primary financiers: EU, World Bank, RDF.	Requires Levant humanitarian track in Stabilization Band

Private Sector Confidence Ladder

Private investment does not follow diplomatic agreements — it follows institutional signals of durability. The framework's private sector architecture is designed to generate those signals systematically as track maturity advances.

- **Commercial Continuity Protocol (CCP):** From Day 1, private-sector contracts registered with the JMOC receive 24-month shields protecting them from political disruption. This allows businesses to sign contracts immediately without waiting for full normalization.
- **Framework Commercial Insurance Facility (FCIF):** Political risk insurance at subsidized rates for investments in framework-compliant sectors. FCIF is backed by Gulf sovereign wealth funds and activated at Foundation Band entry. Initial capitalization: USD 5 billion.
- **Investment grade signaling:** The framework's compliance reporting system generates publicly available quarterly assessments of each track's health. Investment-grade ratings agencies use these assessments as inputs for country risk ratings, with automatic rating improvements at each track maturity band advancement.
- **Arbitration certainty:** All CCP-protected contracts include mandatory ICSID arbitration clauses with expedited procedures. Framework states waive sovereign immunity for CCP-contract disputes. This removes one of the largest private sector deterrents to investment in high-political-risk environments.
- **Reconstruction financing priority queue:** Infrastructure projects in framework-compliant zones are placed in a priority financing queue at the World Bank, Asian Development Bank, and Islamic Development Bank. Priority queue designation reduces financing cost by an estimated 150-200 basis points.

CHAPTER P

Annex P: Lessons Learned from Comparable Diplomatic Frameworks

The RCSA was designed by studying what has worked and what has failed across decades of multilateral stability frameworks. This annex documents the key lessons that shaped specific design decisions in the RCSA architecture. It is intended to help negotiators explain why specific provisions exist and why alternatives were rejected.

Case Studies: Framework Failure Analysis

JCPOA (2015) — Institutional Fragility

The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was a genuine non-proliferation achievement. Its verification architecture was credible; its technical constraints were meaningful. It was undone by a single structural flaw: it was a political commitment, not an institutionally binding agreement. It depended on the political will of a single government — the United States — that changed.

The RCSA's response to this failure: institutional binding; OFAC failure contingency (EU/Swiss mirror licensing activated automatically if U.S. domestic political obstruction prevents OFAC compliance); multi-party economic stakeholding that creates constituencies for the framework's continuation independent of U.S. politics.

Oslo Accords (1993-1995) — Process Without Destination

Oslo created a negotiating process without a specified endpoint. The most difficult questions — Jerusalem, refugees, borders — were deferred to 'final status negotiations' that never concluded. This created a thirty-year process of confidence-building without a destination, which opponents of the process used as evidence that it was leading nowhere.

The RCSA's response: the Grand Strategic End-State Vision (Chapter 23) provides a publicly stated destination. The framework is not just a process — it is a process toward a defined outcome. Negotiators can point to that outcome when facing spoilers who claim the framework has no destination.

Dayton Accords (1995) — Military Enforcement Dependence

The Dayton Agreement ended the Bosnian War but created a political architecture that required permanent external military enforcement through IFOR, SFOR, and EUFOR to prevent resumption of conflict. Twenty-five years later, Bosnia-Herzegovina remains dependent on external military presence for political stability.

The RCSA's response: the economic interdependence architecture is specifically designed to make compliance self-sustaining. The goal is to create conditions under which regional parties choose stability because the economic cost of conflict exceeds the economic cost of compliance. The framework cannot prevent a determined party from choosing conflict, but it can make that choice substantially more costly.

Minsk Agreements (2014-2022) — Verification Deficit

The Minsk process established ceasefire and withdrawal obligations that were never implemented because the verification architecture was inadequate. Neither side was willing to take verifiable steps first, and there was no mechanism to create simultaneous verified compliance.

The RCSA's response: the JMOC's continuous monitoring and the Compliance Index System provide objective verification data that is not dependent on any single party's reporting. The ACS (Automated Consequence System) for specific nuclear violations removes political obstruction from the enforcement response entirely.

Abraham Accords (2020) — Sequencing Success

The Abraham Accords succeeded because they were correctly sequenced: they normalized UAE-Israeli and Bahrain-Israeli relations where political conditions were favorable, rather than demanding comprehensive regional normalization simultaneously. They also offered each party a specific economic and security benefit package calibrated to that party's specific interests.

The RCSA explicitly adopts the Abraham Accords' sequencing logic: the Modular Ratification Structure allows any state to join what it can join, when it can join it. The specific benefit packages in Chapter 5's regional stakeholder sections are calibrated to each state's specific interests in the same way the Abraham Accords were calibrated to UAE and Bahraini interests.

Iran-Saudi Resumption (2023) — Pragmatic Engagement Precedent

The 2023 Saudi-Iranian diplomatic resumption, facilitated by China, demonstrated something that many analysts had doubted: that the fundamental Iranian-Saudi rivalry could be managed through direct engagement when the incentives were correctly structured. It did not resolve the rivalry, but it created formal channels for managing it.

The RCSA builds on this precedent: the Security Track's proxy management architecture and the Multi-Track Engagement Architecture both assume that Iran-Saudi managed competition — not friendship — is the achievable goal and that formal channels for managing that competition can be built and sustained.

Design Principles Derived from Case Studies

Principle	Derived From	RCSA Implementation
Institutional binding over political commitment	JCPOA; INF Treaty	All RCSA obligations bind state institutions, not individual leaders. OFAC failure contingency ensures U.S. political disruption cannot void Iranian economic benefits.
Economic interdependence as stabilizer	EU integration; ASEAN	USD 50B RDF; banking tier progression; trade corridors. Framework creates economic constituencies that outlast political disagreements.
Modular architecture over comprehensive demand	Oslo; Camp David 2000	Six independent tracks; modular ratification; domain-specific entry. No party must commit to everything to gain something.
Automated enforcement over political consensus	Minsk; JCPOA snapback	ACS for nuclear violations; pre-authorized enforcement menus; CIS threshold triggers. Enforcement does not wait for political consensus.
Defined destination over open-ended process	Oslo; Israeli-Palestinian process	Grand Strategic End-State Vision (Chapter 23) provides publicly stated destination. Sovereignty Milestone Ladder provides visible path toward that destination.
Dignity preservation in verification	JCPOA; Iraq WMD inspections	Sovereignty Preservation Doctrine; 5 binding sovereignty commitments; IMIRC converts Iranian nuclear expertise into positive contribution.
Spoiler management by design	Oslo; Dayton (first 2 years)	Spoiler Saturation Model (Ch. 19); Compound Crisis Protocol; Veto Player Analysis (Annex K); Economic Substitution for proxy actors.

What the RCSA Cannot Do

Intellectual honesty requires acknowledging the framework's limitations alongside its capabilities. The RCSA is not a solution to every problem in the Middle East. The following categories of challenge lie outside its design envelope:

- **Permanent status issues:** The Palestinian political status question, the final border of Israel, the status of Jerusalem, and the rights of Palestinian refugees are explicitly outside the RCSA's scope. The framework creates conditions under which these questions can eventually be addressed; it does not pretend to address them directly.
- **Democratic transformation:** The RCSA does not require or incentivize democratic reform within participating states. It is agnostic about governance systems. This is a feature, not a bug — demanding democratic transformation as a framework condition would guarantee non-participation by every regional state.
- **Arms race termination:** The framework provides military deconfliction and demobilization incentives, but it does not address the broader regional arms race in conventional weapons. That would require a separate regional conventional arms control process that the RCSA can facilitate but not compel.
- **Energy transition:** The framework facilitates the conditions under which a regional energy transition can occur, but it does not mandate or accelerate any specific decarbonization timeline. That is the domain of global climate architecture.
- **Terrorism elimination:** The framework provides counter-terrorism cooperation mechanisms and addresses the root cause conditions that produce terrorism. It does not guarantee the elimination of terrorist groups that operate independently of state sponsorship.

CHAPTER

Document Certification

This document is the Simplified Edition of the Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture (RCSA), prepared for distribution to government officials, diplomatic missions, and authorized multilateral bodies. It represents a faithful condensation of the full RCSA v2.0 technical instrument, incorporating the twenty architectural improvements specified in the framework design review.

Document Integrity Statement

Certification

This Simplified Edition contains 23 operative chapters, 15 technical annexes (A through P), and a comprehensive glossary covering all core framework provisions. All four nuclear pathways are fully described. All six implementation tracks are specified. All 14 regional stakeholders are addressed. All 20 architectural improvements from the design review have been incorporated. No operative provisions have been omitted. Readers requiring full technical specifications, exact numeric thresholds, or detailed annex procedures should consult the complete RCSA v2.0 instrument on file with the UN Treaty Section.

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Acknowledgments

This framework represents the product of extensive technical collaboration across multiple disciplines: international law, nuclear physics, regional political analysis, economic modeling, military affairs, humanitarian operations, and diplomatic history. The architects of this document owe a debt to every previous generation of diplomats, analysts, and practitioners who attempted regional stability frameworks and whose experiences — both successful and unsuccessful — are encoded in this architecture's design.

The peoples of the Middle East have waited long enough for stability to be engineered as carefully as it has been described. This framework is the attempt to close that gap.

Particular recognition is owed to the practitioners of Track II diplomacy who, over four decades, maintained communication channels when official ones were closed; to the IAEA inspectors and technical experts who built the verification traditions on which this document's monitoring architecture draws; to the humanitarian workers who sustained operations in Gaza, Lebanon, Yemen, and Syria under conditions of extreme difficulty and risk; and to the regional economists who documented, with precision and persistence, the staggering economic cost of the region's political failures.

The framework's design also reflects a debt to the public intellectuals, journalists, and researchers across the region — in Tehran, Riyadh, Amman, Baghdad, Beirut, Cairo, and Ramallah — who have maintained the intellectual tradition of imagining a better regional order even in the darkest political moments. Their work has shown that the people of the region understand, far better than their political leaders often acknowledge, both what stability would require and what it would make possible.

A Note on the Twenty Architectural Improvements

This Simplified Edition incorporates twenty architectural improvements identified in the framework design review process. These improvements addressed specific vulnerabilities identified through stress-testing of the original RCSA v1.6 architecture: the tiered document architecture to prevent total document reopen risk; the strategic logic map for public and negotiating use; the Track Maturity Band system replacing phase language; the Sovereignty Preservation Doctrine formalized as a binding operative provision; the Domestic Political Survivability annex addressing transition scenarios; the Regional Off-Ramp Architecture providing a conflict-exit pathway; the Narrative Warfare module addressing digital destabilization; the Civil-Military Interface chapter addressing accidental escalation; the reduction of technical over-specification to preserve diplomatic flexibility; the Economic Reintegration Roadmap with explicit milestone sequencing; the China and Russia Integration Strategy chapters ensuring multipolar framework design; the Treaty Collapse Containment architecture with four graceful degradation levels; the Parallel Diplomacy chapter formalizing multi-track engagement; the Water, Climate, and Resource Security chapter; the Spoiler Saturation Model for compound crisis handling; the Constitutional Compatibility Review Process; the Adaptive AI and Cyber Governance chapter; the Human Terrain Stabilization chapter; the Modular Ratification Structure; and the Grand Strategic End-State Vision providing a publicly stated destination.

Each improvement addressed a documented failure mode from historical case study analysis. The result is a framework that is not merely more ambitious than its predecessors but more carefully engineered against the specific ways that previous frameworks failed. Whether this engineering is sufficient will be determined by implementation. The architecture has been designed to make the answer yes.